The Glorious Great Marvel Illuminating the Profound Meaning

Śrīguhyārthaprakāśamahādbhuta · Toh 1200 · Derge Tengyur
དཔལ་ཟབ་མའོ་དོན་གསལ་བ་རྨད་དུ་བྱུང་བ་ཆེ་བ།

The Glorious Great Marvel Illuminating the Profound Meaning, in Sanskrit Śrī Guhyārthaprakāśa Mahādbhuta and in Tibetan Pal Zabmö Dön Salwa Mé Du Jungwa Chenpo, is a commentary on the Mahāmudrātilaka, a tantra of the unsurpassed yoga class. Opening with homage to Vajrasattva and to the protector whose very self is the Great Seal, it sets out, chapter by chapter, the meaning of that tantra as the author received it from his guru, drawing on the oral instructions of Indian masters such as Indrabhūti, Ḍombipa, Kṛṣṇapa, and Śabari to explain the subtle channels and wheels of the body, the sixteen joys, the union of wisdom and skillful means, and Mahāmudrā as the intrinsic joy free of conceptual elaboration. Its colophon attributes it to Gambhīravajra, a master from Oḍḍiyāna said to have attained the accomplishment of Mahāmudrā, and records its translation into Tibetan by the Indian paṇḍita Prajñāguhya and the translator Yungdrung Nyingpo. It is Toh 1200 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the class of tantra commentaries.

In the language of India: śrī guhyārtha prakāsa mahā ādbhūta nāma
In the language of Tibet: The Glorious Great Marvel Illuminating the Profound Meaning

Homage to glorious Vajrasattva.

Protector, whose very self is the Great Seal,
Whose actual defining mark is self-awareness,
Free of conceptual elaboration, without a body,
Whose nature is the sky of gnosis: to you I bow.

From among the supreme tantras of action, conduct, yoga, higher yoga, and unsurpassed yoga, from that very king of tantras, the Mahāmudrātilaka, comes the very meaning that the glorious guru explained to his disciples and granted to me. Later, through an aspiration born of the scripture of the yoginīs, and by the power of speech without characteristics, so as to converse with my vajra brothers, I write it down, just as I heard it.

Examining the sequence just as the guru established it, first of all the five beginning with the expression are explained. If one asks why: through them

one understands the whole meaning of the tantra, its brief presentation, its extensive presentation, its individual presentation, gnosis, and what arises from gnosis. Therefore it is good to set down the five beginning with the expression. Their order is this: the expression, what is expressed, the relation, the purpose, and the purpose of the purpose.

Here, the expression is the fifty-four written from the consciousness of the six yogas, whose nature is the digit (kalā), the drop (bindu), and so on, onward to the end of the passage called "The Names of Glorious Jñānaḍāka." What the venerable glorious Mahāmudrātilaka speaks is what is expressed. Because these two, the expression and what is expressed, are nondual in essence, the purpose is this: having beheld the aim of taming beings through the reality in which wisdom and method are nondual, the secret empowerment and the rest are bestowed and also received. Finding the fruit after the empowerments and the rest have been obtained is the purpose of the purpose. The word "fruit" means buddhahood itself, or else Vajradhara.

Now I set down the five beginning with the expression, each with its distinctive meaning. The expression is the brief presentation of the tantra. What is expressed is the extensive presentation of the meaning of the tantra. The relation is the individual presentation of the secret empowerment and the rest. The purpose is the gnosis of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. The purpose of the purpose is what arises from the gnosis of the instruction on the meaning of the fourth. The words "arising from gnosis" mean that all gnosis is fully comprehended. That is the master's account.

According to the compiler's account, here the expression is the tantra of the brief presentation. What is expressed is that which has the arms, faces, and so forth set out in the extensive presentation. The relation is the retinue of ḍākinīs set out in the individual presentation. The gnosis that is the purpose is this: for those who are to be tamed through desire, ordinary desire is destroyed by the nonduality of wisdom and method. The purpose of the purpose, what arises from gnosis, is that those in countless world systems who are afflicted by the sicknesses of pleasure, pain, and the like arrive at the state of great bliss. This is the compiler's account as explained by the venerable master.

Here the questioner also says this: "Since the tantra has no 'Thus did I hear,' how can it be the compiler's text?" The vajra master replied: In the root tantra of Hevajra, five hundred thousand in extent, the opening beginning "Thus did I

hear" was spoken. At that time, in the midst of a retinue not other than himself, because all the tantras of the root meaning, the great secret meaning of the yoginī system, were immediately sealed, it was taught from the Ocean of Secrets Tantra, called the Later Tantra of the Mahāmudrātilaka. "Later" means drawn out from what came before; so it is said in the teaching on reality in the glorious Buddhasamāyoga. That is why the compiler did not state "Thus did I hear" and so on. Nevertheless, all the tantras, the root, the sections, and the rest, are the words of the compiler. If one asks why: because the Blessed One Vajrasattva is hard for gods, humans, and others to find, the compiler listened from the Blessed One's own mouth and made it clear to gods, humans, and others. Thus it is not something the compiler said on his own. Here too, the compiler is an emanation of Vajradhara, a bodhisattva great being, lord of the ten grounds.

On "To the Blessed One Jñānaḍāka": with the words "Blessed One, please listen to my request," it was made known to the Blessed One, the glorious great Vajradhara, in order to request the meaning of the consciousness of the six yogas and so forth, which will be explained below. So runs the scripture.

According to another master's account, the meaning here is this. He is the Blessed One (bhagavān) because he possesses the bhaga. The word bhaga refers to the gnosis of the true dharmadhātu, and the one who has the light rays of that gnosis is Jñānaḍāka, the sun. According to another master's account, he is the Blessed One because he possesses the six qualities, beginning with lordship. It is explained that he is a ḍāka, a sky-goer, because he goes in the sky. The meaning of going in the sky, moreover, is explained in the account of the venerable glorious Indrabhūti as follows: Vajradhara, whose nature is the adventitious bodhicitta, is himself the Victor, the essence body.

On "He makes the secret essence-lotus bloom": the secret, as explained in scripture, is "the union of the vowels and consonants." According to another master's account, the secret is the source of phenomena. According to the vajra master's account, it is the three-petaled lotus of the channel of touch. "Essence" means bodhicitta. "Lotus" means that whose nature is wholly red. "Makes bloom" means makes clear; or else it means makes arise.

"Abides secretly within the navel" means that the nondual union of the vowels and consonants spoken of by the master Vajrabodhi, which is manifestly the very being of the great Vajradhara, here abides within the celestial palace of the source of phenomena. According to the vajra master's account, the secret

is supreme joy, the lotus is the joy of cessation, and the navel is the joy of intrinsic nature. The embodiment of these three joys, the adventitious nature, abides between the two joys like water on a lotus petal.

Thus it is said here, from the Ocean of Secrets Tantra:
Between the supreme and cessation,
The three realities, inexhaustible,
Abide within the navel of the secret lotus;
Its self is the secret, the lotus, and intrinsic nature.

On the passage beginning "Five hundred thousand in extent," the meaning there is explained as follows. The Hevajra Tantra, five hundred thousand in extent, is characterized by thirty-two sections, as follows. The first is the section on the Full Awakening of Vajragarbha; the second, the section on Illusion; the third, the section on the Vajra Dance; the fourth, the section on the Manifold; the fifth, the section on the Vajra; the sixth, the section on Mahābala; the seventh, the section on Acala; the eighth, the section on the Consort; the ninth, the section on Kurukullā; the tenth, the section on the Great Haughty One; the eleventh, the section on Vairocana; the twelfth, the section on Accomplishments; the thirteenth, the section on Tārā; the fourteenth, the section on Vajravārāhī; the fifteenth, the section on Light Rays; the sixteenth, the section on Nairātmyā; the seventeenth, the section on Yamāri; the eighteenth, the section on Vajrahūṃkāra; the nineteenth, the section on Pratisarā; the twentieth, the section on the Fire Offering; the twenty-first, the section on Consecration; the twenty-second, the section on the Great Maṇḍala; the twenty-third, the section on the Torma; the twenty-fourth, the section on the Preparatory Rites; the twenty-fifth, the section on Full Awakening; the twenty-sixth, the section on Sealing; the twenty-seventh, the section on the Methods of Union; the twenty-eighth, the section on the Vajra Song; the twenty-ninth, the section on Padmanarteśvara; the thirtieth, the section on Vajrapāṇi; the thirty-first, the section on the Ḍākinī; and the thirty-second, the section on the Ḍākinī. Among all of these, what does not remain in the land of the ḍākas and ḍākinīs consists of words that have come down in succession, from one to another.

"Tantra" means that which possesses the generation stage and the completion stage, endowed with the nonduality of method and wisdom. "Hevajra" means the great bliss perfected through the nonduality of wisdom and method, which is called "the life of gnosis"; it is profound and hard to grasp. "Taught" means that the meaning is explained just as it is.

"The six yogas, the scripture of the yoginīs" is explained thus. The words "the scripture of the yoginīs" mean that, in that king of sections for all the yoginīs, what is explained in the first chapter, the six yogas and what the great Vajradhara taught, follows the order of the yoga tantras. Therefore the word "yoga" is explained: yoga is embracing in union, or else excellence. Their order is this: the first is the excellence of the lord; the second, the excellence of the tantra; the third, the excellence of the compiler; the fourth, the excellence of the time; the fifth, the excellence of the retinue; and the sixth, the excellence of the place.

Knowing that the true and vast reality brought into union by such six yogas, complete in every respect, is immeasurable, and for the sake of those who wish for brevity, the Blessed Lady set out the meaning of the digit, the drop, and the rest, the meaning of the six ultimate yogas. Having greatly pleased the Blessed One with the offering of great delight and the like, and with reverent vajra songs, she asked him this in secret words:

The digit, the drop, the mode,
The mere mode, the supreme, and what is other than the supreme:
The consciousness of the six yogas in their divisions,
Where is the place in which they abide?
From where does the life-breath arise,
And into what does Vajradhara dissolve?
What is the vajra day, and what the night?
What are the junctures, and what the rising?
Where is the time of setting? And the channels,
O supreme lord, how many are there?
Please tell what the characteristic of time is.
What is the purpose of its time?
The workings of the vowels and consonants,
And from where does the sovereign arise?
How many distinct kinds of taste are there,
And likewise of the joys?
At the time of which joys
Is the vajra lord born?
How is the dharmadhātu explained?
And what is the vajra like?
First, what is the word "self"?
What is that which is called "secret"?

What is that which is called "supreme"?
Declare clearly the meaning of "delighted."
Teach how many kinds of family there are.
The aggregates and the rest, the sense sources,
Brahmā, Īśvara, Rudra,
Viṣṇu, and Sadāśiva:
From where do they arise, and where do they abide?
How is their essence the greatest of the great?
Teach how many kinds of seal there are.
What is the Great Seal?
Protector, what are the kinds of offering?
What is the flower there?
Great Protector, the taking of life:
How is it to be understood?
The one who holds the sacred supreme maṇḍala,
What is that Blessed One like?
What is the goddess there?
To whom does the word "goddess" refer?
Blessed One, how many charnel grounds are there?
What are the trees there?
Of the charnel grounds and the trees,
Lord of victors, declare the places.
Protector, the inner fire offering,
The sequence of the five nectars,
The gathering of the yoginīs,
And the language there: what is it like?
The very essence of oneself:
Great Protector, please declare it!

To the fifty-four questions asked in such a sequence, the supreme lord himself gave a detailed teaching there. It is right, then, that I too should set it down here according to the master's account, distinguishing the definitive meaning from the provisional meaning. If one asks why: the vajra master too taught the sequence of the tantra. In the tantra's sequence, the limbs of empowerment come first. Therefore, having made the meaning of empowerment fully clear, one should afterward examine the setting of the entire tantra. If one asks why: a disciple who has been properly empowered becomes, in body and so forth, a

vessel for the meaning through the profound instructions. Otherwise, if the meaning of the tantra is made clear without empowerment, both master and disciple incur a root downfall. So it is said.

This is the explanation of the first chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write out the profound words of the second chapter. From "The Blessed One declared" up to the end, it is explained in its plain meaning. On "sequence" and so on: the word "sequence" is to be set out as with the sprout and so forth that come from a seed. Or else, what is called "the four repetitions" is to be taken in its plain meaning. Empowerment is what purifies the stains of attachment and the like. The words "explained as divided into three at the time of the result" are to be examined in the context of cause and result.

On "the master" and so on, the meaning is explained thus: it means the body of the Buddha Vajradhara, who through the water, the crown and the rest is lord of the eleven empowerments. "Secret" means the enjoyment body; "wisdom gnosis" means the Dharma body; the fourth is the body of great bliss. The sequence of what is called "the master, divided into eleven" is this: water, crown, vajra, bell, name, the three pledges, the observance, the prophecy, and the giving of protection; so they are called.

"The twelfth, the secret" means tasting and experiencing, with the defining characteristic of the enjoyment body, the awakening mind in which the conventional and the ultimate are nondual. "The thirteenth, wisdom gnosis" means knowing the gnosis that is the perfection of the power of wisdom, and then, free of elaboration and nondual, entering the gnosis of suchness. Accordingly, "suchness, the fourteenth" is nothing other than entry into the gnosis of suchness. Gnosis is the nature of space, the very body of great bliss, the Lord of Secrets: so it is explained in the sequence of the tantra. The rest is explained in its plain meaning.

On "the division of ground and result into three", the meaning is this: whatever is the cause is itself the root. Here the word "root" is said to mean the nature of supreme radiance, the Dharma body. That, moreover, is divided into three: body, speech and mind. That which is the meaning of the vase empowerment and so forth is body; the secret empowerment is speech; the wisdom gnosis empowerment is mind. "Their result" means this: the renowned one born of mind, great bliss, is victorious. Or else, the meaning of "the result divided into three" is this: the fourth is the cause, because it is gnosis, the nature of space;

and so, as the result, it is itself the essential nature of the three. So the glorious Vajradhara has said.

On "It is to be known through the distinctions of joy": in the empowerments, by the outer sequence results such as the Stainless ground are attained; by the inner sequence, the results are joy and the rest. As for "the cakras", the meaning is this. At the time the vase empowerment is conferred, from union and kissing comes joy in the cakra of body. At the time of tasting the nectar, from feeling a touch that transcends the world, through the secret empowerment, comes supreme joy in the cakra of speech. From experiencing the bliss of wisdom and method joined in equality comes the joy of cessation in the cakra of mind. Where there is no mindfulness of any distinction between self and other, whatever joy spreads forth in the cakra of gnosis is the joy of intrinsic nature. So it is stated in the text of the venerable Indrabhūti.

On "the third day of the waxing fortnight" and so on: according to the text of the Brahmin-like One, at the time the secret empowerment is conferred, three drops of the awakening mind are to be taken. "The mouth of method" and so on are explained according to the letter. The one of twelve years belongs to the time of the speech empowerment. If one asks why: because she is not a lotus woman (padminī), the secret, the awakening mind, is guarded. The one of sixteen years belongs to the occasion of the wisdom gnosis empowerment, for the sake of both the guarding and the arising of the gnosis of supreme joy. The one of twenty years is to be avoided, because the purpose of both the secret and the wisdom gnosis empowerments is not found in her. So too the Blessed One Vajradhara has said that those who have reached twenty and beyond put the accomplishment of the mudrā far off. According to the text of the vajra master, one who has reached twenty agitates the awakening mind, and because of that agitation the arising of joy is not achieved. This has been gathered into the higher yoga tantra (yogottara).

On "the sister and so on, when the signs are found": it is taught that these are to be understood at the time of the three empowerments. Why is that? The signs are the cause of the five gnoses, and since the cause is present, the result is found without doubt. For a lord of yogins in whom the result of gnosis has become manifest, there is no wrongdoing through the sister and the rest. That, for the present, is the level of conventional truth. At the level of ultimate truth, at the time of the inner vase empowerment she is "sister", because she makes clear the distinctions of the moments; at the time of the secret empowerment she is "daughter", because she milks joy; at the time of the

wisdom gnosis empowerment she is "wife", because she makes all tastes shine forth. The root text states the passage beginning "The wife should be offered to the master" in the context of the conventional, in its plain meaning.

On "I myself, in the form of the guru": this means the venerable Vajrasattva himself. On "from worshipping me, accomplishment is found": the intent is that great gnosis is attained. On "immediately, the mahāmudrā" and so on, the meaning is explained thus: after the fee has been offered to the venerable guru, and after the worship and so forth, the accomplishment of mahāmudrā is bestowed. The intent is this: the wisdom consort, having been properly worshipped with substances such as flowers and incense and meditated upon in the form of a goddess, is to be approached and given, for the sake of contact with all the limbs of the disciple. That is for the sake of the inner vase empowerment, and the victory vase too is to be held in the hand. At the time of the secret empowerment, in order to familiarize the disciple with gnosis, the master should first perform the approach through various methods of union. The awakening mind that arises through the approach and union is to be let fall into the disciple's mouth, to be placed there: this is the meaning of the tantra according to the letter.

According to the meaning that is not according to the letter, whatever empowerment arises for the other, the disciple, is "my own place." According to the text of the master Kṛṣṇa, "my own place" is the core of the vajra jewel, and "the other's place" is the core of the lotus jewel. According to the text of the master Kukurāja, "my own place" is supreme joy, and "the other's place" is the joy of cessation. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, "my own place" is the generation stage, and "the other's place" is the completion stage. According to the venerable master Ḍombipa, "my own place" is what arises from method, and "the other's place" is method. Other masters take them to mean gnosis and arisen gnosis.

On "the ring finger, the thumb" and so on: in the outer meaning, the awakening mind is poured from within the core of the vajra jewel down into the disciple's throat, and the two channels of the throat are to be pressed. If one asks why: by this, one afterward knows it just as it was experienced, and that which has the defining characteristic of self-awareness genuinely arises. So the meaning of the tantra is explained according to the letter, and the example for it is this: it is like the loving delight of a maiden, and so forth. Just as for a king's daughter in the full bloom of youth, who has never experienced the bliss of desire, the bliss of loving delight that one most skilled brings about

through amorous union on that first occasion is beyond compare and beyond words: so runs the text of another master. According to the text of the vajra master: just as on the first occasion a maiden in the bliss of loving delight does not feel any of the various distinctions at all, so likewise, from the pressing of the channels of the throat, one does not feel any outer thing at all. "Thumb" means the vajra jewel; "ring finger" means the nonconceptual lady; "joining" means through the act of embracing in equality. According to the text of the master of Oḍḍiyāna, the ring finger is the source of phenomena (dharmodaya) and the thumb is the vajra. According to the text of the Kashmiri master, the ring finger is the navel and the thumb is the seed. According to the text of the master of Jālandhara, the ring finger is the secret tip and the thumb is the secret channel.

On "the enjoyment is to be brought within": according to the text of the venerable master Avadhūtī, it is by each covering the other's limbs with the awakening mind and the honey of the flower. According to the text of the vajra master, the seed of the vajra is to be prepared in the place of supreme joy. According to the text of Oḍḍiyāna, it is to be consecrated in the place of the joy of cessation. That is the sequence of the secret empowerment.

Now, following the text of the vajra master, I shall write on the wisdom gnosis empowerment. On "Life and cutting are to be made equal": in the outer meaning, it is to be taken in its plain meaning. In the inner meaning, "life" is the time of going, and "cutting" is at the time of coming; by the word "time" is meant the moment of experiencing the bliss that transcends the world. "Are to be made equal" means making them of one taste, after which, as taught, the vajra maiden is to be worshipped with loving delight, and exceedingly. "Loving delight" means without agitation. "Exceedingly" means for a long time.

As for "the mantra hūṃ phaṭ at the opening of the jewel", the meaning is this: having set hūṃ phaṭ at the opening of the center of both the lotus and the vajra, "the lotus is to be stirred upon it." In the context of the explanation to the assembly, at the time it is explained to the disciple, "upon it" means the awakening mind. According to the text of the master of Oḍḍiyāna, it is the navel; according to the text of the Kashmiri master, the bird-faced one; according to the text of the master of Jālandhara, the self-arisen; according to the text of the master of Kāmarūpa, it is wisdom and method embracing in equality.

"At that time" and so on is explained with this meaning: at the time of union in equality in the wisdom gnosis empowerment, it is just as the moments and the joys arise for the master. It should be told to the one of sixteen. If one asks why: because she understands correctly, at the time the disciple is empowered the wisdom consort gives signs of the moments and so on, and through signs well given, a mind free of error regarding wisdom gnosis is accomplished. That is the intent. The passage beginning "Afterward she is to be given to the disciple" is explained by the literal meaning of the words.

On the passage beginning "It abides in the center of the heart of the lotus": "the heart of the lotus" is the vessel of the precious buddha, and "abides in the center" means that it dwells in the place where the hare-marked moon descends. Why is that? To write out its own meaning: it is the channel of Vajradhātvīśvarī, the Sovereign Lady of the Vajra Sphere. The vajra opens the secret lotus; and because it enriches the jewel by pouring into it the element, the seed, the master taught that it is called Vajradhātvīśvarī.

"Buddhahood comes by no other means": these words refute all other instructions, as well as meditation and the like. "When it is not found" is explained thus: because that channel of Vajradhātvīśvarī is free of any aspect, the Blessed One said it is "subtler than the subtle." One may wonder, "Where is it to be found?" and, "Since it is not found, what becomes of the tantra's instruction?" For this, the method is explained as follows. Although Vajradhātvīśvarī is free of any entity, even so, through the guru's instruction, by feeling in her merely the appearance of something tangible, the mind of one's own experience becomes unshakable. Here the example is given thus: in a pleasure grove of ketaka flowers the wind has no form; yet when one whose faculties are clear and who has discernment has ascertained it, the moment he merely smells it he experiences a fragrance never known before. In the same way, what great joy does one who understands experience through merely touching Vajradhātvīśvarī! Through the practice of gradual familiarization, buddhahood is attained.

This is the explanation of the second chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write out the profound meaning of the third chapter. "Then" is the setting of all the tantras. And although, after the second chapter, on empowerment, the glorious venerable Vajrasattva himself declared the meaning of the setting of all the tantras by teaching it extensively, nevertheless, first of all, for now, the venerable vajra master, following the

text of the venerable glorious Indrabhūti, has said of "Then": "Although it partakes of the nature that is unborn from the beginning, it brings all things into being."

"Secret" is the nature of the light of the sun. "The drop is taught" means the fire of the mode, which has the aspect of the vajra seed. "Supreme" means the seed of the lotus, renowned as supreme joy. On "the other supreme, having the mode of its own essence": it is the highest of the most supreme, beyond supreme joy. On "the final supreme": adorned with the five spaces, it is the joy of intrinsic nature, the king of great bliss. This states the brief teaching of the cause, in terms of the six unions and consciousness.

Now the result is explained in detail:

In the body, which is the five aggregates,
O lord of loving delight, are six cakras.

Here the distinct cakras are indicated with words of address. The vajra master explained its own meaning thus. The cakra of wind is at the navel, and from the soles of the feet upward: that is in the context of explaining to the assembly. At the time of explaining to the disciple, it is within the secret lotus. The cakra of fire is a triangular form, not at its center; according to the text of Oḍḍiyāna, it is outside the navel. The cakra of emanation is at the navel, the cakra of Dharma at the heart, the cakra of enjoyment at the throat, and the cakra of great bliss at the crown of the head.

Like a half moon, the very digit itself,
Threefold, in the form of the cakra of wind.

The Blessed One spoke this in the provisional meaning. According to the text of the vajra master, the definitive meaning is "the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā." She is neither half nor full; like the moon in water, by this example, she has wholly abandoned apprehended and apprehender. Because, though she herself is unborn, she brings about birth in all, she is the Great Illusion. Though free of elaboration, she holds the share of life for the three realms without exception. Because she is the nature of space, she is peaceful. Because she gives supreme joy, she is supreme. Because she comprehends wondrous joy, she is the other supreme. Because she is the essential nature of the joy of intrinsic nature, she is inconceivable. Because existence and nirvāṇa are nondual, she is unborn. On "the one renowned as life, in the cakra of life," it is stated thus: the very self of outer and inner, she is the mistress who gives birth to the cakra of wind. If one asks why, the intent is that by nature she is

the essence of wind.

It dissolves within the cakra of fire:
A single cakra without letters.

This is the Blessed One's scripture in the provisional meaning. According to the text of the vajra master, it is the Blessed One, a being of the vajra family, renowned as Vajra, the king of great bliss. According to the text of the venerable master Kukkuripa: because mirror-like gnosis is unmoving in essence, it is without letters. Because it is the nature of the great emptiness, it is all aspects. Because it is mere consciousness without aspects, it abides in all. Because it is the essence of consciousness with aspects, it pervades all; or else, because it is the nature of space. Because it is the essence of the nonduality of wisdom and method, it is the source of bliss. Because it is the nature of supreme joy, it increases bliss. Because it is the nature of mental consciousness, it is free of the letters, vowels and consonants. Because it is the essential nature of great bliss, it is the one that moves through all the three realms without exception.

On "The mode is the place of the adventitious": this is the Blessed One's scripture in the provisional meaning. In the definitive meaning, according to the text of the vajra master, it is the glorious king greatly renowned as Vajra, free of elaboration; who, when wisdom and method embrace, is aware through the mode; who spreads forth wondrous joy. Through that joy, merely by hearing of it, recalling it and experiencing it, even the tathāgatas find the bliss of great bliss; the joy that comes from partaking of the bliss of an outer woman is not like that. Therefore, because it is not outer, it is free of all aspects: so the Lord Saṃvara has said. Because it is hard for the śrāvakas, the pratyekabuddhas and others to grasp, it has the form of a nāga's tongue, which is utterly terrifying. Just as even a hero is afraid on seeing the tongue of a great snake, so the joy that arises for Vajradhara is something even the buddhas cannot bear; how much less, then, others, gods and humans!

On "the agent in space and the rest", in the outer meaning it is explained thus: the word "space" means the heavens, and the words "and the rest" mean the human world and the underworld. In the inner meaning, they are supreme joy and the others. According to the text of the venerable master Ḍombipa, they are the moments, beginning with variety. According to the text of the venerable glorious Indrabhūti: because gnosis is free of form, it is without letters; because it is free of the tangible, it is without elements; because it is

free of taste, it is without the lengthening mark; because it is beyond sound, it is without the bindu dot; because it is stainless, it is immeasurable; because it is self-arisen, it is unborn; because it is the nature of space, it is inexhaustible. This is the ultimate view: so runs the text of the glorious Indrabhūti.

On "at the navel" and so on: this was written above. According to the text of the master Kṛṣṇapa, the navel is nothing other than the cakra of emanation. According to the text of the master Vīrabhadra, as regards the completion stage, there are five cakras of emanation. The Glorious Ocean of Saṃvara, the Tantra of the Great Ocean of the Suchness of the Great Family, and others are similar. In short, the King of Tantras in Two Sections (the Hevajra Tantra) and others were declared not in extensive form, for the benefit of those who want what is condensed. Or else, the intent is that it is because those who practice the Dharma have little wisdom.

In the cakra of Dharma, the mere mode
Is stainless, like a serpent's eye.

As for these lines, they are the Blessed One's scripture in the provisional meaning. In the definitive meaning, according to the text of the vajra master, it is this. When the first joy arises in the Blessed One, in the Tathāgata who abides on the ground of Vajradhara, through the various rays of light of that joy the eight great tastes, truly wondrous, arose. Having seen this, the Supreme Lord afterward taught: the supreme of the great secret; "the mere mode," that is, supreme joy; great gnosis fully spread forth; and "in the cakra of Dharma," by means of the sandalwood, through the places in their sequence. "Stainless, like a serpent's eye" is merely a figure of speech; nevertheless, by it utter stainlessness is shown.

Or else, in the definitive meaning, the word "serpent" means the enjoyment body. According to the text of the venerable Kyelari, it is the increase of appearance; according to the text of the venerable master Vajranaṃ, the rising of the vajra sun; according to the text of the venerable Kamalavīrī, the drop piercing gnosis; according to the text of Queen Lakṣmī, freedom from the five elements, earth and the rest. For that very reason Vajradhara said it is "truly stainless." "Because it is without parts, it is without elaboration": so runs the text of another master. "Because it is stainless" is a phrase that qualifies it. Stainless means uncontrived and free of aspects; because it is without aspects, it has no location; because it has no location, it is unmoving. The meaning is that it is the nature of the space of gnosis. Because gnosis is the

nature of space, it is beyond example. "Having neither center nor non-center" means beyond existence and nonexistence. "The mere mode, the supreme gnosis, the lord of the gods does not know" means that it is not known even by Viṣṇu, the Great God (Śiva), Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), Upendra and the rest.

The supreme abides in the cakra of enjoyment,
The supreme nectar of supreme aspect.

These lines are the Blessed One's scripture in the provisional meaning. According to the text of the vajra master, the meaning in the definitive sense is this. When supreme joy, great gnosis, arose in the Blessed One, the great Vajradhara, the buddhas and bodhisattvas dwelling in countless world systems, and the immortals, their bodies ablaze and their minds parched, fell fainting to the ground. Seeing them thus unable to bear it, the great Vajradhara made the most fierce joy fade from appearance, and he who is renowned as supreme, whose defining characteristic is great peace, spread forth what is called the final joy. The meaning of complete enjoyment was explained before. It is called "supreme joy" because in it all the joys, the moments and the tastes come to fullness; and "supreme nectar" because it is the cause from which all things arise. According to the text of the venerable glorious Indrabhūti, at the point when the eyes cannot bear it, it is the supreme nectar, because one experiences incomparable bliss. According to the text of the venerable master Kukkuripa, it is the supreme nectar because it is unshakable.

"The first of the supreme" the venerable master explained thus: in the joy whose essence is complete in the supreme, whatever mass of light rays there is, that is the first of the supreme. On "the end of the supreme", the procedure is stated thus: the truly fierce supreme is joy, and that which is fully pacified is just that; that is the end of the supreme. "Abides there" means "arises there". "The end renowned as supreme" is a joy, of which I shall write immediately. According to the text of another master, "supreme" is the first joy, "the end of the supreme" is the joy of cessation, and "abiding there" is the joy of intrinsic nature. According to the text of the venerable glorious Indrabhūti, "the first of the supreme" is the principal itself, "the end" is its conclusion, and "abides" is said because it is without movement. The text of the venerable master Kukkuripa is similar.

On "just as the taste of liquor is its essence", the vajra master said this: by an outer example, just as there is joy in the taste of fully ripened grapes, so

through the taste of the awakening mind, in which the conventional and the ultimate are nondual, there is a peaceful joy, wondrous and never known before.

By the end of the supreme, in joy,
The aspects of form and the rest are stopped.
Therefore
It abides, its nature free of form,
The nature of all, without any entity.

This the Supreme Lord himself has said.

In the cakra of great bliss, the other supreme
Abides at the end of the end of all.

This the Blessed One spoke according to the letter. According to the text of the master who attained accomplishment, the meaning is explained thus: on the occasion when the glorious great Vajradhara abode in the final joy, the nature of great peace, he saw all the tathāgatas thus fainting out of fear of emptiness and falling to the ground; and so afterward the Blessed One, renowned as the bestower of the supreme, turned it into the joy of great wonder, and it shone forth. On "the cakra of great bliss": according to the text of the venerable master Kukkuripa, it is the place where great bliss is felt, the core of the secret jewel. On "abides at the end of the end of all", it is said thus: the words "the end of all" mean the final joy, and "its end" is the distinguishing of what is not that. According to the text of the son of the glorious Indrabhūti, "the end of all" is the joy free of joy, and "abides at the end" is the joy of intrinsic nature. Therefore:

Joy whose defining mark is delight in gazing,
Free of every mark and every non-mark,
Inexpressible, inexhaustible and peaceful,
The very reality experienced as one's own joy,

is Vajrasattva: so it is said. The passage beginning "Through the kindness of the guru's feet" is explained according to the letter.

Joining upper and lower in equality,
The place of the sphere of union:

so the characteristics of the cakras are explained. According to the text of the venerable master Ḍombipa, in the core of the secret lotus, below is the cakra of wind and above the cakra of fire; below, the cakra of the navel, and above,

the cakra of Dharma; below, the cakra of enjoyment, and above comes the cakra of great bliss. According to the text of the master Vilāsavajra, the petals are each distinct, while the hubs are joined. According to the text of other masters, the inner petals are joined; hence it is taught that they have the form of union. "Half of twelve" and so on gives the measure of the number of petals of the cakras. Their order is this: the cakra of wind has six petals; the cakra of fire, three; the cakra of emanation, sixty-four; the cakra of Dharma, eight; the cakra of enjoyment, sixteen; and the cakra of great bliss, thirty-two petals.

This is the explanation of the third chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

On "seventy-two thousand", the meaning is stated thus: that which is the nature of the five aggregates, up to the crown and the very top of the head, is pervaded by a network of seventy-two thousand inner channels. Among them the foremost are three; some take two. Concerning "all-joy", the names and signs are stated in the glorious King of Tantras of the Great Family.

Here the number of the six cakras is taught in brief. If one asks why: whatever is a petal is itself a channel. Moreover, just as the names are taught, so too are the characteristics.

O Goddess, without the arising of the channels,
How could the aggregates and the rest arise?

On this it is explained thus. The body is the very nature of the five aggregates, and the body is like a foundation. Moreover, because its foundation, the channels, is hard to destroy, it does not perish. Because it does not perish, the two accumulations of merit and gnosis are accomplished, and from that comes buddhahood. According to the text of another master, the aggregates depend on the channels. According to the text of the master Kukkuripa, they are connected with one another equally. According to the text of the venerable master Ḍombipa, the outer channels have become the support of the aggregates and the rest. According to the text of the master Indrabhūti, they are twofold, of outer and inner nature. According to the text of the master Vilāsavajra, they perform the function of a support, endowed with water and the other elements. The teaching of the names of the channels that comes next is not written here, because it is clear in the tantra.

Without the aggregates, how could the yogin
Find the great syllable?

This is explained as follows. Because the channels are the support, the awakening mind arises. That is the attainment of the result of the wisdom gnosis empowerment, and through that comes great gnosis, Vajradhara himself: that is the meaning. The intent is that otherwise great gnosis would not be attained.

The body, the nature of the five aggregates,
Is renowned as the five ḍākas.

On this, according to the text of the master Śākyamaitri, it is also explained thus. The aggregate of form is Buddhaḍāka, and "Buddha" is Vairocana. The aggregate of feeling is Ratnaḍāka, and "Ratna" is Ratnasambhava. The aggregate of perception is Padmaḍāka, and "Padma" is Amitābha. The aggregate of formations is Karmaḍāka, and "Karma" is Amoghasiddhi. The aggregate of consciousness is Vajraḍāka, and "Vajra" is Akṣobhya. One may wonder, "How can the five aggregates be ḍākas?" On this the master explained thus: in the aggregates are, by nature, the five ḍākas; but in the human state they are covered by adventitious stains, just as the moon and the sun are covered by clouds, darkness, smoke and the like. "The buddha maṇḍala does not exist in that way": so runs the text of the venerable Nāgārjunagarbha.

The nature of the elements is explained in terms of the five gnoses, in this order: mirror-like gnosis, the gnosis of equality, discriminating gnosis, the gnosis that accomplishes activities, and the gnosis of the Dharma realm. Thus the body formed of the five aggregates, whose nature is the gnoses and so forth, is not formed without the arising of the channels; and this is the scripture saying that without the aggregates the yogin does not find accomplishment. The rest is explained according to the letter.

Through forms that have the aspect of goddesses,
In the body whose reality is the channels:

following the sequence of the scripture, this is explained according to the text of the master Jñānabodhi. The network of seventy-two thousand channels, in the context of its explanation in the root tantra of the Great Family, is, through being purified as goddesses, the maṇḍala of the retinue. According to the text of the master Kṛṣṇapa, it is in the maṇḍala of the ḍākas, consisting of five hundred thousand; according to the text of the master Vilāsavajra, in the maṇḍala of the section on the ḍākinīs. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, a brief teaching of the number of the channels is found also in the

tantras of definitive meaning, and their purification as goddesses is found too; but the Blessed One did not teach it in the sequence of a maṇḍala. Taking up that intent of the venerable Indrabhūti, the master Karavīra explained as follows. Having emanated the cakra of the channels everywhere in the forms of goddesses, for the sake of entering the maṇḍala of the great pledge, and in order to experience in a single instant the bliss of loving delight with all the yoginīs, the great Vajradhara himself abides in equal embrace. According to the text of the master Bodhi, they come into equality because this is the cause of the birth of the moving and the unmoving.

The meaning of "the element of the tangible" and so on is explained thus: the element of the tangible is the source of phenomena, which means the secret lotus. "The banner" is the secret vajra. "By union" means embracing in equality. The meaning of "the water-born within the cakra of fire" is this: the cakra of fire is the triangular place, and the water-born (the lotus) within it is the vessel of the precious buddha. According to the text of the master Śabari, through the water-born within the cakra of fire, the vajra is to be aroused from the experience of the bliss of both, expanding in equal measure. According to the text of the master Anaṃbhagavajra, the secret lotus is of the nature of wind, and the secret vajra of the nature of the sun:

By these the cakra of fire is fully expanded.
When the vajra is set in motion,
Then the fire is realized.

So it runs in the sequence of the tantra, and the vajra master declared as follows: the vajra is the essence, the awakening mind; the fire is the self-arisen flower. According to the text of another master, the vajra is method and the fire is wisdom. According to the text of the master Śākyamitra, the vajra is the nature of the vowels (āli), and the fire the nature of the consonants (kāli). According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, the consonants are of the nature of fire and, from gnosis, the vowels are of the nature of the vajra; and gnosis comes to be fully realized. According to the text of the master Kukkuripa, through the union of the vowels and the consonants, fire and vajra are both realized at one and the same time.

On "victorious through the clarity of the vajra" and so on, it is explained thus: when the vajra and the lotus both open, the lotuses of the cakras located at the navel and the other places blossom fully, and so the awakening mind is deposited like honey. According to the text of the master Ḍombipa, after the

six cakras have fully expanded, the channels drip. According to the text of the master Indrabhūti, the lotus of each cakra is itself a channel. That text accords with reasoning; otherwise the purpose of the individual things would not be accomplished. Accordingly, "like water in a broken vessel": so Vajradhara himself has said, in the sense of nonduality.

Then, on the passage beginning "the site of the cakra of emanation," the vajra master has given an extensive explanation. Here I write down the texts of only a few masters and settle the matter according to its meaning. Meditators who have not experienced the gnosis of the channels take hold of the Blessed One's provisional meaning and accordingly meditate on nothing else. And even then, mere knowing does not bring their minds to understanding. If one asks why, it is because the Blessed One, speaking figuratively, establishes things through the provisional meaning. For the sake of fortunate beings, the masters who attained accomplishment, such as glorious Indrabhūti, make that same point clear through the definitive meaning. Likewise, whatever is made clear through the unbroken succession is taught there with reasoning.

In that regard, according to the text of the master Kukkuripa, the five channels whose nature is the five elements, gathered in the cakra of emanation, are the definitive meaning. Their sequence is this: śukrabhaha, raktabhaha, rasabhaha, madhabhaha, and mutrabhaha.

On "From the tips of both channels," the vajra master explained as follows. Within the cakra of fire, to the right and left of the center of the secret lotus, the sun and the moon drip like little female snakes. The word "moon" means śukra (semen), and the word "sun" means rakta (blood). According to the text of glorious Indrabhūti, what is called mada drips from within the self-arisen flower. The two channels in the middle of the womb are like ropes, resembling little female snakes. This should be drawn right away as an illustration.

On "That cause should be known as one alone," it is said as follows. "Cause" means the root, and the root here is Avadhūtī, whose nature is selflessness. That itself, in the form of all things, divides into two, into three, into four, into five, into six, into eight, into twice eight, into four times eight, into eight times eight, and into seventy-two thousand. This explains the perfect result that comes from the root that is the cause.

"śukra arises on the left": this is a scriptural statement of the Blessed One with both definitive and provisional meaning. According to the text of the vajra master, it is like this: the single one divides, through the awakening mind, into

two, into three, into four, and into five. Its meaning is this. When the moment of variety arises, it becomes solid through the mere touch of bola and kakkola (the vajra and the lotus). When joy arises, it melts. When supreme joy arises, it becomes hot. When the joy of cessation arises, it moves. When the joy of intrinsic nature arises, it takes on the nature of space. In this way, through the nature of the five great elements, the single awakening mind of great bliss is explained. Therefore it sometimes flows to the right, sometimes to the left, sometimes in the center, sometimes upward, sometimes by the lower path, and sometimes everywhere.

On "When on the right the sun" and so forth, the text of the master Kṛṣṇapa says this. The word "sun" means the life force (prāṇa). When the life force arises, śukra becomes entirely red in nature. The word "moon" means the secondary life force. When the secondary life force arises, śukra becomes white in nature. The word "fire" means the vital essence, which is absorbed within both śukra and rakta, like the life within an egg that cannot be seen. The text of the master Vimalavajra explains this meaning with reference to taste. The text of the master Indrabhūti explains this meaning with reference to the awakening mind whose essence is supreme joy. The master Kukkuripa explained it in the same way with reference to what has the essence of the joy of intrinsic nature.

After that explanation, the vajra master explained the combination of the elements in terms of generation. On the passage beginning "By the wind of former karma, consciousness," make a distinction: for gods and humans dwelling in saṃsāra, former karma is the cause of virtue and nonvirtue; in the case of the Blessed One Vajradhara, former karma arises as Tathāgatahood itself, for the benefit of all sentient beings. According to the text of the master Ḍombipa, karma is the gnosis encircled by the four moments. According to the text of the master Vilāsavajra, it is the union of joy. According to the text of glorious Indrabhūti, it is the unfolding of suchness. According to the master Kukkuripa, it is the appearance of supreme light. Because that itself has the nature of mental consciousness, it is the wind of intrinsic nature. As for "saṃsāra," in the case of ordinary beings it is ordinary existence; in the case of the great Vajradhara, it is the radiating of the light rays of the joy of intrinsic nature. This is the pith instruction of the vajra master.

"When, on whatever occasion, the joy of intrinsic nature becomes solid, then, at that time, the father transformed the mother's mind of great passion": this is a scriptural statement of the Blessed One with definitive meaning. The vajra

master's explanation of its meaning is this. The word "father" means the great Vajradhara. On "transformed the mind through great passion": rising from the great ocean of the joy of intrinsic nature, the one renowned for great passion, abiding in supreme joy, embraced in union, for the sake of the cause of birth in countless world systems, the wisdom yoginī Nairātmyā, possessor of the bhaga endowed with the stream of reto. The word reto is explained as all the times beyond the world. According to the text of the master from Oḍḍiyāna, it is the joy of cessation. According to the text of the Kashmiri master, it is the supreme joy of great light rays. According to the text of the master from Bengal, it is the first joy. The meaning of fire and sun arising clearly is that āli and kāli arise; according to the text of the master Śabari, it is that supreme joy and the joy of cessation arise.

The meaning of "Then, the mind of great passion" is explained as follows. The Blessed Lady Nairātmyā looked upon the selfless world, and by joining the one possessed of magical illusion with the one possessed of wisdom as persons, she displayed the embrace of the ḍākinī for the sake of birth in the three realms, illusory in aspect and of the nature of great desire. "Desiring touch" means dissolving, for the sake of birth as gods and humans, into the union in which wisdom and means are not two.

As for "The bola entering the kakkola," the meaning is this: the vajra known as bola entered deep into the kakkola, which has the form of the secret, and, like water within water, it became the bodhicitta in which the conventional and the ultimate are not two. Some take this to speak of the two, the lotus and the vajra. According to the text of the venerable Indrabhūti, "water" is the seed that arises from the vajra, and "within the water" is the nature of the thoroughly red that arises from the lotus. That is why Vajradhara himself said, "From that, the cause that arises from the seed."

"From the seed it is born as a mass" means that the Tathāgata comes to arise, for the word "mass" signifies the body. According to the text of another master, the mass has the form of the embryo in its arbuda stage. From that, first the channels arise. Later, through the process of the firm stage, the stirring of the limbs, and so on, the aggregates and the rest come to arise, so it is said.

This is the explanation of the fourth chapter from the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write out the meaning contained in the fifth.

On "Dwelling within the secret anus": according to the venerable master's text of the tantra of the secret lotus, "secret" is explained otherwise, as the heart of the jewel. According to the text of the master Vīrabhadra, it is none other than the source of phenomena (dharmodaya). According to the text of the instructions of the glorious Indrabhūti, that place of touch which is hard to see is the anus. That is why Vajradhara himself taught it as "the secret body."

As for "There, the great unborn digit (kalā)," the venerable vajra master said that the words "great digit" mean the yoginī Nairātmyā. According to the text of the master Vilāsavajra, it is like the fiber of a young lotus in the secret place. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, it is the lunar day of ultimate bodhicitta. That is why the Supreme Lord himself used the word "person." Further, "free from consciousness" is explained as Nairātmyā herself. "Wisdom body" is explained thus: she who is Nairātmyā is herself the very body of wisdom. "Selflessness" is definitively shown to be the essence of emptiness. On the word "emptiness," too, the venerable vajra master gave this explanation, teaching it definitively: "emptiness" has the meaning of nonconceptuality. According to the venerable noble Nāgārjuna:

The conventional is taught as emptiness;
Emptiness is the conventional.

As for "Abiding there, the life-force arises," the venerable vajra master explained it in these words: from the selfless state, free of conceptual thought, there arises the bodhicitta in which the conventional and the ultimate are not two, the life-wind of consciousness. This in turn means the lifespan of the supreme life-force in sentient beings. As for "the great life-force, ever the very self," the meaning is stated thus: it is always present in the intermediate state of existence.

"Residing in the five abodes" is intended as "abiding in the five great elements." Some read it as "the five circles." On what is known as the five elements, the venerable vajra master said this: the five great elements are five with space as the fifth. "Adorned by it" means pervaded. If one asks what it is, it is the life-wind.

On "Space dissolves into space," it is said thus: the word "space" means bodhicitta, and the second "space" is that of the five great elements. "Dissolves" means that it gives rise to the great touch. According to the text of the master Saroruhavajra, "space" is consciousness, and "space dissolving" means abiding pervasively in the five great elements. According to the

venerable glorious Indrabhūti, "space" is the life-force, and the second "space" means mutual reliance and union with the five great elements. The glorious Vajradhara said this very thing:

The four great elements
Should be known as supports for the life-force;
Or else, the life-force relies on them.
This should be known, O Lady of Perfect Delight.

On this very point the Supreme Lord himself makes the meaning of the great elements fully clear in the sequence of generation:

From consciousness, wind is born;
From that, fire comes to arise;
From that, water comes to be born;
From water, earth comes to arise;
From that, the aggregates truly arise;
From the aggregates, the sense bases;
From these, the natures of wisdom,
In a sequence of one hundred and eight.

On this, the venerable guru, following the sequence of the twofold tantra, set out the measure of the natures of wisdom:

Blazing, agitation, and anger,
Pride, and viewing all directions,
Open shamelessness,
Dripping, and full expansion,
Coquetry, arrogance, and play,
Thoughts attached to wealth,
Scrutinizing women, mistaken reckoning,
Dryness, victory, and waking from sleep,
Weariness, and shedding tears of joy,
The mind's wavering, and running,
Nonconception, sickness, and vanishing,
Laughter, song, and a joyful mind:
Twelve, with seven more besides.
In each period of two watches,
They arise in sequence in the limbs of wisdom.

On this, according to the text of the noble Nāgārjunagarbha, the meaning of the venerable vajra master is explained thus: "wisdom" is the all-base

consciousness, and its "limbs" are its circling; that itself is the nature of Nairātmyā. Although it is the nature of Nairātmyā, relying on the body it performs functions such as going, just as a great log, relying on the great ocean, is made to circle about. According to the text of the master Utpala, consciousness is in essence of the nature of wind. According to the instruction on the natures by the venerable glorious Vajraputi, this is brought about by the karmic wind. Throughout two watches, at the time it reaches the twenty-seven places, it experiences the enjoyments of karma for half a water-clock period each, and afterwards it also circulates fully in that same sequence by way of the lower path.

Thus, throughout night and day, there are enjoyment, dissolution and mastery with respect to the one hundred and eight natures. On this, the sequence of the instructions of the master Kṛṣṇapa and others is as follows.

When the all-base consciousness, riding on the karmic wind, takes up its abode at the crown of the head, what is known as mastery becomes the sign of blazing in the body. When it abides at the top of the head, enjoyment becomes the sign of confusion about anything. When it dawns at the right ear, it becomes the sign of non-appearance. When it comes to abide at the spine, the sign of pride arises in the mind whose essence is mastery. When it comes to abide at the left ear, enjoyment arises as the sign of looking in the directions. When it abides between the eyebrows, the nature of non-appearance arises as the sign of the body passing urine. When it abides in the eyes, the nature of mastery arises as the sign of shamelessness. When it comes to abide at the bases of the two forearms, the nature of enjoyment arises as the sign of the dripping of śukra (semen). When it comes to abide in the two armpits, the nature of non-appearance arises as the sign of the mind's expansion. When it comes to abide at the two breasts, what is known as mastery arises as the sign of pride. When it comes to abide at the navel, the nature of enjoyment arises as the sign of arrogance. When it comes to abide at the tip of the nose, the sign of play arises from the nature of dissolution. When it comes to abide in the mouth, what is known as mastery arises as the sign of thinking of wisdom. When it comes to abide at the throat, the sign of attachment to wealth arises. When it comes to abide at the heart, the nature of non-appearance arises as the sign of thirst. When it comes to abide at the root of the sexual organ, what is known as mastery arises as the sign of fainting. When it abides in the sexual organ, the nature of enjoyment arises as the sign of waking from sleep. When it comes to abide at the anus, the nature

of non-appearance arises as the sign of weariness. When it abides in the thighs, what is known as mastery arises as the sign of satisfaction in joy. When it comes to abide at the two shins, the nature of enjoyment arises as the sign of the mind's wavering. When it comes to abide at the toes, the nature of non-appearance arises as the sign of running. When it comes to abide at the soles of the feet, what is known as mastery arises as the sign of incomprehension. When it abides at the big toes, the nature of enjoyment arises as the sign of sickness. When it comes to abide at the two knees, the nature of non-appearance arises as the sign of the mind being lost. When afterwards, in upward sequence once more, it comes to abide at the wheel of mind, what is known as mastery arises as the sign of laughter. When it comes to abide at the wheel of speech, enjoyment arises as the sign of song. When it abides at the wheel of body, the nature of non-appearance arises as the sign of joy.

Thus, in these twenty-seven places, as the all-base consciousness travels upward and downward, at the times of arising from the natures of wisdom there are non-appearance, enjoyment and mastery. On these, the instruction text of the venerable glorious Kamalaśīla gives the meaning of the vajra master's text as follows. In the experience of one's own bliss, whatever is unclear, or else is fully immersed, is non-appearance. The experience of the great bliss in which the conventional and the ultimate are not two is enjoyment. Whatever is free of confusion through the view of their wisdom is mastery. In the Vajramālā Tantra and others, what is to be done is stated literally.

The meaning of "night," then, is examined just as the venerable vajra master stated it:

Night is known as wisdom;
Wisdom, the night, becomes the sky itself.

Thus, in the essence of nonduality, this is the word of the Blessed One, by way of both the definitive and the provisional meaning.

According to the instruction of the venerable master Śabari, she who is fully endowed with the marks, who has reached twelve years of age, and who possesses an indistinct lotus is wisdom, conceived as night. According to the text of the master from Oḍḍiyāna, she is of a nature not renowned, born of one's own family. According to the text of the Kashmiri master, it is the Kashmiri mind, set wandering by the stirring of sense objects. According to the

text of the master from Kāmarūpa, she is dark blue of limb and sixteen years of age. According to the text of the venerable master Kukkuripa, it is the full moon of bodhicitta.

On "Wisdom, the night, the sky itself," the venerable guru explains the meaning thus: "wisdom" means one who has reached the bloom of youth; "night" means one blinded by great desire; "the sky itself" means a slight opening of space.

As for "the form of night," because the bodhicitta abiding in the lotus of space is exceedingly white, it is matched with the moon. Being supreme, it bestows supreme joy and is of the nature of nirvāṇa. According to the text of the master Kṛṣṇa, because it bestows the joy of cessation, it is of the nature of nirvāṇa.

On these words spoken by the Blessed One,

Here wisdom is divided in two:
The realities of the conventional and the ultimate,

the venerable vajra master spoke according to the literal sense.

On "The conventional, the unborn touch": in the context of the generation stage, she is blessed in the form of a deity, and for the tasting of nectar in the lotus of touch she is endowed with sixteen years. According to the text of the glorious Vajraputi, it is the karmamudrā whose nature is inner. According to the venerable master Ḍombipa, it is the bird-face. According to the venerable master Kukkuripa, it is the root of the life-force.

On "The ultimate, free from touch, she who generates": according to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, it is the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā. According to the instruction of the venerable master Kukkuripa, it is the nonconceptual channel, the bliss that is free from touch. On "Hard to see, hard its defining character": because it cannot be expressed, its literal meaning was declared. On

Having the nature of no intrinsic nature,
Its night I have explained,

this was made a code term in the context of the completion stage.

On "Day is known as means," the venerable master explains as follows. By the word "day" is meant the jewel radiant with the rays of the sun. "Means" refers to a person like that; or else, it is "means" because one thinks only of means in order to attain the ground of Vajradhara in countless world systems. On

"Means becomes the sun," this makes clear the meaning of means. According to the text of the master Kṛṣṇapa, it is the bodhicitta whose essence is supreme joy, arising within the jewel of the secret vajra.

"Arising from the bhaga, it becomes the sun": this is the word of the Blessed One, by way of both the definitive and the provisional meaning. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, the bhaga is wisdom, the sun is means, and "arising" is bodhicitta. On "The sun, lord of the bhaga": means is the protector of the wisdom consort; or else, it is what brings about realization. According to the text of the master Śabari, the bhaga is the blossomed lotus of wisdom's womb, "sun" means the self-arisen flower, and "arising" means being born from that. According to the text of the master Vajrarāga, the bhaga is of the nature of the joy of cessation, the bodhicitta, the sun, is the essence of supreme joy, and the word "lord" signifies natural joy itself.

On "The form of existence becomes the sun," the venerable vajra master explained this in keeping with the sequence of the King in Two Examinations (the Hevajra Tantra): one meditates on the instruction of wisdom-gnosis and experiences the great taste, and likewise, in the wheel of the jewel of the secret vajra, the place of great joy, there arises a joy whose essence is unbroken and undivided. Because that itself is exceedingly clear, it is the sun. On "The moon, the essence of nirvāṇa": it is the very absence of perception, on the side of great joy, that comes from the joy of wisdom-gnosis. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, it is nonconceptuality itself. According to the text of another master, it is the joy of cessation.

On the passage beginning "That existence is explained as the family," the text of the glorious Prahastistavajra Udaya explains as follows: "existence" is the all-base consciousness; "family" is the body in which the five aggregates are complete; "in the moon" means in the intermediate state of existence; "family" means taking up existence; and "from the sun" means through the mindfulness gathered by former aspirations. According to the venerable master Ḍombipa, "existence" is means and "family" is wisdom. According to the text of the master Saroruhavajra, "existence" is śukra, of the nature of supreme joy, and "family" is rakta; the meaning is that the family is born in the moon, the bodhicitta, and that the sun is the rakta. According to the master's text, because that seed of awakening, which has the nature of nirvāṇa, is fully formed, it has become of the essence of rakta. When it has become its own defining characteristic, it becomes like the vajra jewel. When it comes to move through a slight force, it takes on the form of birth. That is from the standpoint

of the generation stage.

From the standpoint of the completion stage, because there is no elaboration, "the sun is accomplished" means that the bodhicitta of supreme joy is free from the family of conceptual thought. That which is without conceptual thought and without parts is the excellent and the supreme. Because it is excellent and supreme, it is subtle. Because it is subtle, it is nothing whatever. Because it is nothing whatever, it is the body of emptiness. Because it is the body of emptiness, it is radiance. Because it is radiance, it is great peace. Because it is great peace, it abides in all. According to the text of the glorious Padmaśīkara, the intent is that just as space pervades everything, so radiance abides in all that are known as the natures. As for "day" and the rest, these are to be taken literally.

In the passage beginning "The two junctures meet," "juncture" means transition, "two" means wisdom and means, and "meet" means union. As for "vajra," "lotus," "sun," and "moon": since wisdom and means are joined as two, that which unites them is the meeting of the two organs known as vajra and lotus. Or else, it is the moon and sun that arise from them: by the word "moon," śukra is meant, and by the word "sun," rakta.

In "The meeting of the two navels" and so on, "two" means both. In both organs, of wisdom and of means, that which is the place of the essence is "the two navels." "Meeting" means that, on the occasion of experiencing the wisdom-gnosis empowerment, the secret jewels come together through the guru's instruction. "The defining characteristic, through an instant of subtle viewing" means that the inner view is accomplished. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, from the meeting of the two tips, the great secret jewels, that drop which is the appearance of the drop of bodhicitta, in which the fruit of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment is experienced, is beheld with the view of touch in the middle between the two sides.

In the passage beginning "The juncture transcends elaboration," the juncture taught earlier has the character of elaboration, while the one explained below is free of elaboration. That is why the Blessed One spoke of it as free of aspects, as supreme, and as supreme beyond the supreme. In the passage beginning "Abiding in the middle of the two meetings," according to the text of Prahastistavajra Udaya, it is the wisdom in which the conventional and the ultimate are not two. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, having abandoned the two sides of entity and nonentity, it is simply the lamp of

gnosis, so that the yogin may achieve siddhi. "Fully freed from smearing and oil" means that "smearing" is saṃsāra and "oil" is nirvāṇa, and that it is free of them. That is the literal sense of the words "juncture" and the rest.

On "Dawning" and so on, according to the text of the master Śabari: so that beings might be born as gods and humans, the Blessed One, the great Vajradhara, made manifest his compassion that takes sentient beings as its object. By means of accomplishment and the great sādhana, the beings of the lower realms entered his mouth through the hook of gnosis, and he set them in the abode of great bliss in the form of the nectar of the melted moon. On that occasion, that which is great joy is the first dawning, and that which is the completion of the emanation that is not other is the joy of cessation.

On "The tip of the knot, the supreme place": in supreme joy, which comes when the time of emanation has arrived, the place of residing in the wheel of the vajra jewel is the fourth. The word "place" is explained as the dawning.

"Shaped like the edge of a canaka (a chickpea)": according to the instruction text of Jñānapāda, from the standpoint of the generation stage it is the drop of bodhicitta. The text of another master discusses it in terms of the completion stage.

On "That itself is to be known as the mouth," according to the text of the master Ḍombipa, that drop of joy is itself the drop of the joy of cessation, the mouth or door; or else, it means the path. On "The mouth is twofold," the meaning is that the joy of cessation, too, has a mouth: the path of the emanation of cessation. According to the text of the noble Nāgārjunagarbha, the twofold door is definitively stated to be permanence and annihilation. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, the drop of bodhicitta that has the form of a canaka kernel is the place of the knot of the maṇḍala wheel; "mouth" means the door of the inner goddesses, and "twofold" means the outer door. That is from the standpoint of the generation stage. As for the completion stage, the bodhicitta that has the form of a canaka kernel is the arising of supreme joy; "that itself, the mouth" is the door of the vajra jewel, and "twofold" is the door at the center of the secret lotus.

According to the text of Prahastistavajra Udaya, "dawning" means the all-illuminating bodhicitta of both the conventional and the ultimate. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, "dawning" is supreme joy; the word oṃdha denotes the joy of cessation, whose essence is the notion of night; the word "lord" denotes that whose essence is the notion of the moon; and "night

going upward" is natural joy.

"Night is known as equal to the drop" refers to bodhicitta, the king of moons, which has the nature of the four joys. "The drop is divided into four" means, from the standpoint of the stages, the distinctions of outer appearance, mastery, enjoyment, and wisdom. On "Beginning, end, and middle": at the beginning there is enjoyment, in the middle mastery, and at the end non-appearance; that is from the standpoint of the generation stage. From the standpoint of the completion stage, at the beginning there is non-appearance, in the middle enjoyment, and at the end mastery. "The fourth is not found" means that wisdom is free from both the generation stage and the completion stage. As the Blessed One, Vajradhara himself, said:

Since it is self-awareness by nature,
It therefore cannot be expressed.

The words of the passage beginning "That is explained thus" are to be taken literally.

The meaning of "setting" is explained by the vajra master: "when" means that at whatever time the mind whose nature is the three joys dissolves into a taking up whose nature is the spreading of the appearance of the dawning, then it should be known as setting. This is intended to mean that it happens through the slowing of the light rays. According to the text of the master Ḍombipa, "setting" is cessation. According to the text of the master Śabari, it is as in "It comes to go where there is no going"; it is the very melting of the bodhicitta whose essence is free of melting. "When it goes from the beginning to the end" is like this: at the time when, having abided in supreme joy, it is in the place of the joy of cessation, then it sets. According to the text of Vīrabuti: from the first joy, make it set in the place of the joy of cessation. On "At the end, setting is fully shown," according to the text of the master Śabari, "the end" is the joy of cessation and "setting" is cessation. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, the meaning is that the joy of cessation brings about the equanimity that gives rise to joylessness toward all joys. "From the stable place to the unstable place": with these words the Supreme Lord definitively makes fully clear the definitive meaning of setting itself; and that the bliss of the stable and the rest comes from the bliss of the unstable is to be taken literally.

This is the explanation of the fifth chapter from the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write out the explanation of the profound verses of the sixth.

On the passage beginning "Time is taught as the division of occasions," according to the text of the master Kṛṣṇa, it is like entering into the root conduct. According to the text of the master Saraha, "time" means exertion in the inexpressible sādhana, and "occasion" means the arising of bodhicitta at a single time. On "Time is divided in two," according to the text of the brahmin woman Vajravatī, it is the union of generation and completion. On "inconceivable time," according to the text of Princess Lakṣmī, it is great joy, merely the essence of the natural wind that arises from the tip of the rasanā, the right channel. According to the text of Queen Śrībhadrā, it is the joy of cessation, which by nature comes from the life-wind arising from the life channel. On "The good time is called the occasion," according to the text of Princess Lakṣmī, it is the joy of touch, which has the nature of the secondary life-force arising from Vajradhātvīśvarī. On "The good time, and likewise the bad time," the text of Queen Śrībhadrā explains them as supreme joy and the joy of cessation. According to the text of Princess Lakṣmī, it is the bad time because of extreme joy, and the good time because of being exceedingly supreme.

"From the openings of the two nostrils": according to the text of the royal Vajrakarkatiri, the doorway path by which śukra and rakta descend into the place where great bliss is felt is what "nostrils" means. The great bliss, free of elaboration, that is experienced by way of that path is "time": this is the text of the yoginī Lakṣmī, who attained siddhi in her first birth, before the glorious Indrabhūti himself. And although there was no contact with Princess Lakṣmī's method, the venerable vajra master spoke of it, because it is taught in the treatise composed by the master Śākyamitra, now mentioned. That, for now, is the text of the yoginīs who attained siddhi.

Now, examining the meaning set out in treatises by the sovereign yoginī: "That fear is taught as the bad time" means that, in the context of the outer meaning, the coming and going of the two, the life-force and the secondary life-force, through the two nostrils is to be understood just as it is. As for the entry by way of the inner nature, "the utmost time" means that bodhicitta, riding on the life-wind, comes from the wheel of great bliss downward, as far as the place where great bliss is felt.

"Going is called the bad time" means reaching another place from there: this is the text of Jñānamūrti. On

The bad time is to be known as the joy of cessation;
The good time is endowed with the most supreme,

the Supreme Lord himself spoke, making the meaning taught fully clear. "Suchness free of the two" is natural joy, free of going and coming, of arising and its exhaustion: this is the text of Padmaśakha. That is why the Blessed One stated this very point:

Thus, time itself has no before.

On the passage beginning "Joyful to behold":

Because by nature it is the essence of wind,
Free of the defining marks such as aspect,
And of the defining mark of liberation hard to gain,

this means that what cannot be found through meditation and the like, and is free of all ill marks, is the moment of cessation, completely free of its own limbs: this is the text of the master Vilāsavajra. The passage beginning "Thus, time" was declared in its literal sense.

On "At that time the mind is not elsewhere, if one practices yoga," according to the text of the glorious Mahāsukhavajra: at the time when supreme joy and the joy of cessation arise, the yogin, with the bodhicitta endowed with mental consciousness, from the place of great bliss,

When he makes it stir,
Then surely, though moved, it is not spent;
He becomes like Vajradhara.

That is the real meaning. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, the intent is this: when the yogin experiences the mind free of the conceptual thoughts of arising from supreme joy and the joy of cessation, of perishing and abiding, of entering, going, coming, and so on, at that very time he is Vajradhara.

On the passage beginning "āli and kāli (the vowels and consonants) arise," the text of Prahastistavajra Udaya states this: the word āli is wisdom, the word kāli is means, "arising" is bodhicitta, and "from what" means through the union of churning and the great means of churning. The rest is literal. That, for now, is the completion stage, by way of the great secret meaning.

From the standpoint of the generation stage,

Born from the abode of radiance,
Having the nature of great illumination,

means kāli, the wisdom sun. "The thirty-three consonants" are the syllables from kā down to ha. Free of illumination, as distinct from the sun of great illumination, is āli, the body of the wisdom moon. "Endowed with sixteen vowels" means the syllables from ā up to ā. According to the text of the master Ḍombipa, rakta is kāli wisdom and śukra is āli wisdom. By a distinctive point in the text of the master Kukkuripa, the very essence of kāli wisdom is the emanation body of the glorious venerable Vajrasattva, and through the essence of āli wisdom it is the body of the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā.

On the passage beginning "Those very two in union," the meaning is that from the churning and the means of churning, in which transcendent means and wisdom are united, there arises bodhicitta, whose nature is the nonduality of the conventional and the ultimate, the slow great taste, possessed of perception. According to the master's text, "slow" is bodhicitta of the nature of emptiness, and "great taste" is of the nature of compassion. According to the text of the master from Oḍḍiyāna, "slow" means that the joy of cessation, of nondual nature, the great taste of the bodhisattva, arises, possessed of perception. According to the master's text, "slow" is bodhicitta of the nature of emptiness, and "great taste" is of the nature of compassion. According to the text of the master from Oḍḍiyāna, "slow" is the joy of cessation, bodhicitta of nondual nature, and "great taste" is of the nature of supreme joy. According to the text of the Kashmiri master, "slow" has the essence of the conventional, and "great taste" is of the nature of the ultimate. According to the text of the master from Bengal, "slow" is the essence of the generation stage, and "great taste" is the completion stage. According to the text of the glorious Indrabhūti, "slow" is the culmination, and "great taste" is free of culmination. According to the text of the master Bheraputra, "slow" is the essence of non-appearance, and "great taste" is the essence of enjoyment.

Hence, "The very taste of the supreme nectar arises from the nose-tips of the consort": according to the text of Princess Lakṣmī, it arises from the place at the heart of the channel of Vajradhātvīśvarī. "It fully illuminates the sixth wheel" means that the great taste just spoken of penetrates the lotus of the staff of life, the support of the body: this is the text of the master Āryadeva.

On

There, she who brings touch to be found;
The eight great tastes are to be known,

as for "there, the mouth," it is the mouth of Vajradhātvīśvarī, the act of the bliss of touch. "The eight great tastes" are wisdom: the signs, such as trembling, at the time the great fruit is attained. "The taste of touch" is what makes the joys and the rest manifest. In the passage beginning "The taste arises," "the taste arises" means that the signs are realized, and on that basis the joys arise. According to the text of the master Vilāsavajra, "arises" means becomes manifest, and "Truly excellent, it is born" means of a nature that is not ordinary. According to the text of the master Vimalamudra, it is free of outer examples and the like.

On this, the sequence is as follows: joy, thorough joy, the joy of cessation, and natural joy. On "What is called joy is appearance," according to the text of Prahastistavajra Udaya, on the occasion of the churning and means of churning of the great Vajradhara, when joy, the nature of things, arises, a nature of full clarity appeared in the moon, the sun, and the stars. The appearance in the world that comes from that is the meaning of joy.

Now I shall write out the meaning of intense joy. At the great time of churning and the means of churning, when great joy, whose essence is the support, arises, the rays of the various suns shine clear for the immortals who dwell in the heavens, and from that, the spreading of appearance through countless world systems is the meaning of intense joy.

Now I shall write out the meaning of the joy of cessation. On the occasion when great passion blazes, for the asuras who dwell below, the nature of humans becomes clear in all directions, and from that, appearance is attained from the seven underworlds upward. That is the meaning of the joy of cessation.

Now I shall write out the meaning of intrinsic joy. Intrinsic joy has the nature of supreme light. In it the arising of appearance, joy, and the rest is clear; that is the meaning of the term. According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, at the time when the fruit of the four empowerments is experienced, whatever joys arise in one who meditates, in them appearance and the rest are the signs of gnosis. According to the instruction treatise of Master Kukkuripa, the four joys come from meditating on the stages of the instruction on the single wisdom-gnosis, and in each joy the gnosis of appearance and the rest arises.

On the lines,

At that time the moments arise,
Characterized as variety and the rest,

it is explained as follows. The word "that" refers to what is to come, and "supremely" means the cause. Its plain meaning is this. First of all, from the root cause of supreme light come variety, maturation, destruction, and freedom from characteristics, which are the arising of the causes of the joys. After that come the joys themselves, which are the results. As for "appearance and the rest," what it teaches is supreme light alone; since that is the nature of both cause and result, all the others are excluded. According to the instruction treatise of Master Vīrabu, supreme light is free of cause and result.

Now the time at which the joys arise is explained. The Blessed One declared,

When the mind is within the knot,
Then joy will be experienced.

Following the sequence of this declaration, the venerable vajra master explains it as the place of the knot at the jewel wheel of the vajra. According to the treatise of Master Vilāsavajra, it is the place of the navel. According to the treatise of Master Śabari, it is the place at the root of the vajra. According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, it is the same as the scriptural word of the Blessed One. According to the treatise of Master Jñānasari, in the case of the wisdom consort it is likewise.

By the word "mind" is meant the inner nature: the arising of the inner seed at the time when touch is experienced through the vase empowerment. On "then," meaning "at that time": whatever contentment there is in the thought "All outer things are contrived" is what arises from joy. So says the instruction treatise of Padmaśrīka.

The meaning of "About three barleycorns from the knot" is this. When the secret empowerment is experienced and bodhicitta descends from the place of the jewel wheel of the vajra, then whatever understanding there is that outer things have the intrinsic nature of an illusion, that is supreme joy. "From the third place it goes to the third" is explained thus: "the third place" is about one finger-width from the jewel wheel, and "to the third" is about one finger-width. According to the treatise of Master Śabari, it is the mouth of the jewel. When the meaning of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment is experienced and bodhicitta descends there, then, because there is no mindfulness distinguishing self and other, that very not feeling anything at all is the joy of

annihilation. According to the treatise of Master Santakuri, in the joy nothing appears and nothing arises.

The meaning of "free of the three" is explained thus: leaving aside about two finger-widths from the grain, it is the place where intrinsic joy arises. According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, "the third" is from the lower portion, all of that up to the upper portion, and that which, of the middle portion, is the size of the tip of a fine hair is the place of intrinsic joy. That, for now, is the account in terms of the support. In terms of what is supported, intrinsic joy dawns merely through experiencing the great appearance of great touch, which is characterized by self-awareness.

Now, the passage beginning "The great secret" is stated just as the words say. Further, on the passage beginning "The dharmadhātu is renowned," following the sequence of the great Samāja Tantra, it is explained as follows. "Dharma" is free of elaboration; "dhātu" has elaboration; and what is called affliction is the intrinsic nature of emptiness. Therefore glorious Vajradhara declared that space itself is the dharmadhātu itself. "The element is known as the seed" refers to bodhicitta in its conventional nature. "All phenomena are within" is explained to mean that the world of beings dwells within. "Reason" (hetu) means the cause from which all the world systems without exception arise. "The supreme place" means the intrinsic nature of the vajra of mind. "Just as ghee and the like are made" is stated just as the words say; that is from the perspective of the generation stage.

From the perspective of the completion stage, on the lines,

The dharmadhātu is renowned as the bhaga;
The word bhaga is existence, the arising of supreme joy;
The bhaga that gives birth is the vessel of the jewel,

according to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, it is the lotus made of the channels of touch. According to the instruction treatise of Vīrabhūti, "jewel" means bodhicitta, and "vessel" means the lotus made of the three channels. According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, "jewel" means rakta (blood), and "vessel" means camphor. According to the treatise of Master Avadhūtī, the word bhaga signifies the Blessed One (Bhagavān), and the word "vessel" signifies the self-luminous wisdom consort. Therefore it is endowed with the five qualities of lordship and the rest, and the tantra teaches, "That is well known as the bhaga."

Now I shall write out the words that teach definitively on the generation stage and the completion stage. On "Dharma is taught as the bhaga": the bhaga that is known as dharma is the wheel of emanation. The mind that is known as the element is the wheel of speech. If one asks why, it is as stated: "From it, distinctions arose in all the elements." The mind known as having become one is the wheel of mind, and the wheel of mind is the cause that generates the three realms without exception. "Through form in its conventional aspect" is stated just as the words say.

This is the explanation of the sixth chapter from the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, on the seventh chapter, I shall write on the profound verses. The passage beginning "Further" is just as the words say. "Indestructible" means partless according to the treatise of Master Vajrabhūti, and free of arising according to the treatise of Master Śabari. "Embodying the five wisdoms" means having the essence of the mirror-like wisdom and the rest. "Dissolves into space" means into the five aggregates.

"Embodying space" means having the essence of the five Tathāgatas. That, for now, from the ultimate perspective, abides in the center of the core of the lotus. "The single drop, without syllables" refers to bodhicitta, in which the conventional and the ultimate are nondual: supreme joy. According to the treatise of Princess Lakṣmī, it constantly dawns in the center of the hub of the lotus made of the three channels. Because it brings forth the countless, it is the essence of all aspects. Being by nature space, it is in general free of all aspects, and it is vajra because it is Vajradhara, the holder of the vajra.

Now the word "I" (ahaṃ) is explained. The passage beginning with the word "I" states it thus: the syllable a is the secret vajra, and the syllable haṃ is the secret wisdom. According to the treatise of the glorious Padmaśīkhari, the syllable a is bodhicitta, and the syllable haṃ is joy. According to the treatise of Indrabhūti, the syllable a is existence, and the syllable haṃ is nirvāṇa. According to the treatise of Master Kukkuripa, the syllable a is mind, and the syllable haṃ is what arises from mind. According to the treatise of the noble Nāgārjunagarbha, the syllable a is the all-base consciousness, and the syllable haṃ is the mental consciousness. According to the treatise of the glorious Siddhi, the syllable a is the encouragement given by the Tathāgata. According to the treatise of Master Kṛṣṇa, the syllable a is sending forth, and the syllable haṃ is taking back. According to the treatise of Master Bhirapatra, the syllable a is the life force, and the syllable haṃ is the secondary life force. There are

many such treatises by other masters.

Now, concerning the two syllables, I shall write out the excellence of their location according to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa. On the passage beginning "The syllable a at the mountain's peak": "mountain peak" is the jewel wheel of the vajra, at the place where the vajra sun arises. "Peak" is at the place of the core of the secret vajra; according to the treatise of Master Śākyamitra, it is the crest of the vajra jewel. On "The syllable haṃ at the end of the crown's boundary," the meaning is this: "crown" means the place where great bliss is felt, and the place at the boundary of the lotus wheel is the end of the secret tip. What follows is stated just as the words say.

This is the explanation of the seventh chapter from the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, on the eighth chapter, I shall write out the profound verses. On "I shall fully explain the meaning of the great secret," according to the treatise of the glorious Prahastista, the great secret is free of entities and the like.

On "The great secret is great joy": as for the great secret, at the time when the instruction is experienced, the great appearance whose nature is sudden and inward is the joy of the great secret. At that time, the experience of touch whose nature is the great bliss beyond the world is the most supreme joy. After that, the experience of the taste of incomparable touch is the joy of cessation, the very nature of the great secret. On that occasion, the shining forth of the great appearance of gnosis, whose essence is to have no essence, is intrinsic joy, the nature of all. On the occasion of the endless intrinsic nature, what is inexpressible is to be realized. Since that is the great secret, the great secret is the experience of great bliss. That, for now, is from the ultimate perspective.

From the conventional perspective, the Jewel Casket treatise says the following. "The śukra (semen) of the great secret" means the all-base consciousness, and "śukra and the rest" means the wind of consciousness. According to the treatise of Master Kṛṣṇapa, it is wind, which has the nature of a great element. According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, it is what serves as the support of the life force.

On the lines,

The body has the nature of the five aggregates;
Its support should be known as earth itself,

according to the treatise of the glorious and holy Śukrāri, the support of the body is bodhicitta. Of this, the first joy is earth, because it has the characteristic of true solidity. Supreme joy is water, because, being abundant, it has the characteristic of moisture. On "Water is hot to the life force," according to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, the very melting of the nectar of bodhicitta is the essence; according to the treatise of Master Kukkuripa, it is pervasiveness itself. On "The joy of cessation relies on light": the joy of cessation, which is annihilation, is inward in nature; through great passion, the power of fire is radiant everywhere. "Light is at the end" means, according to the treatise of the glorious Mahāsukha, "the place of non-arising at the end of intrinsic joy, renowned as great bliss." On this point, intrinsic joy is free of the generation stage and the completion stage. On "At the end, emission is not taught," it is not characterized by annihilation. On "Relying on emission and non-entity," according to the treatise of Nāgārjunagarbha, it is annihilation. On "Non-entity is declared to be the end," according to the treatise of the glorious Padma Śabari, it means that intrinsic joy, the final culmination, constantly dawns. That is why the tantra itself says, "The end is subtler than the subtle."

On the lines,

Because the renowned intrinsic nature is great bliss,
It is well known as the wind of gnosis,
And is taught as that and as space,

scripture says, "It is the great emptiness of all aspects, because it is of the nature of gnosis." The rest, "It always abides as the nature of all," is explained just as the words say. Alternatively, "It always abides as the nature of all" means, as the Tantra of the Supreme Name says, "Through the practice of diverse conduct, it pervades all things." The treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti is similar to that.

Now the meaning of the five families is explained. "The family is declared to be the kapāla (skull cup)": this is the provisional meaning. In the definitive meaning, the kapāla is the vow of bone, according to the treatise of Master Utamaravajra. According to the treatise of the glorious Sarvabhūti, the plain meaning is this: because glorious Vajrasattva loves the persons to be trained, at the time of the vow of great bliss the families arise from the hub of the vajra. "Of kapāla, ka is spoken first" means "when they are gathered, vajra comes first." This is the instruction treatise of the Ocean of Saṃvara Tantra.

On "ka is first, the root": among all the families, the vajra family is the father; or else, it is what has become the cause of all the families. This is the treatise of Master Vilāsavajra. "The root is divided into five" means the nature of the five Tathāgatas. From them come countless families.

On the passage beginning "The five aggregates themselves, embodying the five Tathāgatas": because they are the very nature of the vajra of emptiness, the ordinary aggregates are the essence of their respective Tathāgatas. If one asks why that is, it is because the Tathāgatas hold sway over the five great elements in all. Those five great elements, moreover, are the gods themselves: Viṣṇu is earth, Maheśvara (Śiva) is water, Mahārudra is fire, Brahmā is wind, and Sadāśiva is space. Among them, one pervades all five. On "I am the ultimate root": this is the nature of great supreme light, the glorious great Vajradhara. "Pervading all" is explained thus: because the light is supremely great, it pervades everything. Granted that the great elements also pervade all, it is great supreme light that illuminates even them. Therefore it pervades all in a special way. According to the treatise of Master Candrakari, the word "all" means the five great elements, and what pervades them and brings forth appearance is the meaning of "great supreme light." It is emptiness utterly free of elaboration. It is without transference, because it is free of arising and perishing. In space there is no returning of anything else. It is unarisen, because it is not manifest and because it is not an entity. The rest, beginning with "compassion that is fitting," is stated just as the words say.

This is the explanation of the eighth chapter from the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, on the ninth chapter, I shall write out the profound verses. "The word mudrā makes one master": this is stated in Sarvabhūti's teaching on the reality of the tantra. According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, from the conventional perspective mudrā is the great observance; from the ultimate perspective it is the sealing with the meaning of gnosis; and from the secret perspective it is the union of means and wisdom. "Sign" means what is drawn from the secret instruction, or else what is included in the secret pledge. The treatises of other masters speak of mudrā in terms of the ways of forming it with the hands and so on. According to the treatise of the glorious Vajrabhūti, the three realms without exception are the very nature of mudrā. The rest the venerable vajra master explained just as the words say.

When Vajradhara spoke of young women of low caste, by way of distinctions of caste, this clearly teaches that in all castes there is no caste by intrinsic nature. If one asks why: for the Tathāgata there is neither caste nor birth. According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, because all are tathāgatas, the Blessed One's distinctions of family are pure, being the complete purity of body, speech, and mind. What is taught with "sister" and so on is for the sake of the arising of gnosis free of conceptual thought: this is the treatise of Princess Lakṣmī. Afterward as well, the meaning is that what is pure in terms of the channels is also not experienced. The intention is that what is pure in terms of earth and the rest is present in all. Therefore one should not make distinctions by way of "sister" and the like: this is the treatise of the yoginī Vajraviti. As for "sister" and the rest, taught in the sense of the six tastes, the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti says that they are to be enjoyed in order to nourish the three realms.

On the lines,

All of them should be worshiped with effort;
Swiftly one will attain accomplishment,

the intention is that they are delighted through the union in which means and wisdom are nondual. If one asks why, the intended meaning is that they swiftly grant accomplishment.

This is the explanation of the ninth chapter from the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write out the profound verses of the tenth chapter. "Regarding stupas of stone, clay, and the like, one who knows reality rejects mudrās and so on": the venerable master stated this following the sequence of the tantra, according to the treatise of Princess Lakṣmī. If one asks why: those who know reality know the essence through the mind. Therefore the intention is that one should set aside deity images of clay and the like, and with the very substances of nectar that arise from the body, which embodies the five Tathāgatas, worship the king of bodies, the abode that dwells in the vajra of mind. The rest is explained just as the words say. The union of the five families and so on was taught earlier by the venerable vajra master. Likewise, with the intention that all are buddhas, distinctions of caste are rejected.

On "What may be drunk and what may not be drunk are to be partaken of": this is a sign for non-conceptuality itself. The words "and so on" mean what is dear and what is not dear. According to the treatise of the glorious Vīrabhūti,

for one who does not abide in the empowerment of wisdom and gnosis: in wisdom-gnosis, what may be drunk is supreme joy and what may not be drunk is the joy of annihilation, and the meaning is that one does not partake of that either. On "One does not say that a woman is not fortunate," it says this: "By disparaging women one does not attain the accomplishment of mahāmudrā." This is the treatise of the glorious Jñānabhūti. The rest is stated just as the words say.

Now, following the order taught in the yoginī tantras, the venerable vajra master explained the places and so on in this order. The places pertain to the time when great and excellent delight arises. What relies on bodhicitta is the place (pīṭha). What increases in the nectar of bliss and relies on it is the near place. What arises again and again in bliss is the field (kṣetra). What expands in bliss in its own place is the near field. Because whatever arises is held as the substance of bliss, it is the chandoha. Because its action brings that from far to near, it is the near chandoha. Because it brings about perfect union with the qualities of bliss, it is the gathering (melāpaka). Because it is near to that, it is the near gathering. "Near" is like the color applied to the outside of a piece of crystal. What, in great bliss, is without entity at the beginning and the end is the charnel ground. What experiences bliss through the characteristic of non-entity is the near charnel ground. That experience of bliss is the increase that pervades perfectly, and through it together with mindfulness comes the near increase. All of these are twelve in nature. From the experience of bliss, because the place is stable, it is the place where great bliss is felt. The inner places are the places of the head and the crown. The outer places are Oḍḍiyāna and so on. The treatises of other masters taught the places and so on, in their meaning, in terms of the syllables a.

"At the time of worship, one should worship." This is explained as follows. "The time of worship" means practice carried out with the pride of being Vajradhara, and the application of the sādhana. As for "worship," with a nondual nature and in the form of the deity, the word means to delight the embodiment of means and wisdom.

On "With flowers of the light of the hare-marked one": according to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, the word "hare-marked one" means the moon, and the word "moon" means the awakening mind. The word "light rays" means "of the drops." "With flowers" means "with what captivates the mind," or else "with what is white." On "The flower, the red sun": this is the self-arisen flower.

The treatise of Master Jñānabhūti explains it thus. "Life" is the awakening mind that abides in the wheel of great bliss. "Partaking" refers to the six faculties in the place where great bliss is felt, within the anointing of the three wheels, and to enjoyment and non-appearance. The word "food offering" means what brings satisfaction. The word "offer" means to experience, and this is in the place of the wheel of great bliss just mentioned. According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, it is the emanation wheel with sixty-four petals. According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, it is in the lotus of the womb of the wisdom consort.

On "One should take life," according to the treatise of the royal Vīramati, one should worship the lotus of the wisdom consort with the flower of the awakening mind.

On "One should not be displeased," the treatise of the glorious Nāgabodhi says: "Within oneself, one should neither abide in nor touch anything other than the supreme joy of means, and one should not have a mind lacking zeal toward the wisdom consort." If one asks why that is: on the occasion of worship, the point of giving and the rest is important. From taking its life one obtains the fruit of merit, whose nature is the genuine and utterly supreme joy. This, following the sequence of scripture, is the treatise of the glorious Padmaśrīka.

Now the secret maṇḍala is taught. Just as it was explained by the vajra master in person, so I shall set it down clearly here. On "triangle and so on": "triangle" is the place where enjoyment, non-appearance, and empowerment are experienced. "Red" is the intrinsic nature of brilliant light. "Fitting" is the essence of the primordial wisdom of the perfectly fitting sphere of phenomena (dharmadhātu). "Two tiers" has the characteristic of support and supported. "Maṇḍala" is the nature of the essence.

As for "On the inner tier, the Glorious One," according to the treatise of Master Śabari, the inner tier is the place of the supported. The word "Glorious" means the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā. "The Blessed One, the awakening mind, the mind" means the protector Heruka, renowned as the drop of the ultimate awakening mind. Further out is the place of the supported. "The yoginīs of the three families" are those whose nature is body, speech, and mind: Rasanā, the Holder, and the Nonconceptual One. According to the treatise of Master Saroruhavajra, that flowing of body, speech, and mind is the purity of the inner maṇḍala.

Now the goddesses are to be inquired into. By the word "goddesses" is meant that lord; this is the treatise of Sarvabhūti, which teaches by way of suchness. The treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti speaks of them as limbs. "The body abides" is the root teaching of the sequence that relies on scripture. If one asks why, the word means the maṇḍala. Because it has the nature of the sphere of phenomena, it is itself explained as the bhaga (the female organ). "Arising from the bhaga" refers to the venerable one of the awakening mind. The word "arising" means "rising," like the moon, victorious in the sky.

On "Dwelling in the midst of the eight charnel grounds," this is explained: the secret maṇḍala, endowed with the limbs of the goddesses, is adorned with outer, inner, and secret charnel grounds. The outer ones, Caṇḍogra and the rest, are places where fire burns. The inner one is the body with its nine doors. The secret one is the place of non-appearance where the breath of the awakening mind, whose nature is bliss, comes forth.

In the treatise of the glorious Mahāsukha, the master explains the eight charnel grounds as follows. In the center of the secret lotus is a red lotus whose eight petals are the channels of touch, and in its center is the awakening mind of the King of Great Bliss. On the eastern petal, because the awakening mind of conventional form has become non-appearance in nature, there is Caṇḍogra, characterized by burning. In the south, because it has become enjoyment itself, there is the One with Form, characterized by not burning. In the west is Gahvara, characterized as having passed beyond enjoyment. In the north, because empowerment has been obtained, there is the Blazing, characterized as not having broken into pieces. In the corner of fire, because it has become the joy of annihilation, there is Host of Hells, characterized as fearsome. In the corner of water, where it has become annihilated, there is the Terrifier, characterized as unbearable. In the corner of wind, because it meets the life wind from the place of annihilation and afterward reaches the place of joy once again, there is Aṭṭahāsa, characterized by the brandishing of a spear point. In the corner of Īśāna (the northeast), because it moves slightly upward, there is the One with Bells, characterized as being held back by the supreme joy.

Thus the slight stirring from the place of the channel petals of the eight charnel grounds of the great secret shows the places of annihilation and the rest. There, the sequence on the channel petals is this: Fierce Might, Might Maker, Supreme Savor, Mighty Sound, Sky Woman, Water Giver, the Putrid One, and the Miserly One. This is because the channels have many limbs and

secondary limbs. The Supreme Lord spoke the very word "tree": this is the treatise of Master Śabari. "The trees of the channels, the flowers and so on, of the tantra": this is the meaning, because the awakening mind comes forth. "And so on" means the self-arisen flower.

On "How could one worship without flowers? It comes about upon the maṇḍala," it is explained thus. The intent is that without the self-arisen flower of the awakening mind, there is no worship, renowned as non-appearance, enjoyment, and empowerment, in the maṇḍala of the mudrā who is the wisdom consort. According to the treatise of Master Vilavajra, because there are no secret flowers and so on, there is no completion in means and wisdom; and according to the yoginī's treatise, neither the mudrā nor the accomplishments are achieved.

This is the explanation of the tenth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, on the eleventh chapter, I shall set down the profound verses. The passage beginning "Listen! I shall fully explain the fire offering" is stated just as the words say.

On "It abides in the place of the navel in its manner": according to the treatise of the glorious Great Secret Vajra, this is the heart of the secret lotus. According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, it is the navel place with sixty-four petals. "Of the secret lotus" was explained by the master in person as the petals of the channels of touch. In the place at its center one should understand the manner. That is why, at the end of "manner," the tantra speaks of the secret lotus. The word "manner" is a word for the adventitious. According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, it is a word for the awakening mind.

As for "There, the autonomous wind," according to the treatise of the master of Oḍḍiyāna, there are the eight channels of touch, and in the very middle of the center of their petals the wind constantly arises in the adventitious manner, with a nondual intrinsic nature.

On "Circling all around, it does not circle," the vajra master in person explained as follows. "Circling all around" means that at the time when means and wisdom are joined in union, although the natural wind arises everywhere, it occurs in particular as a circling to the right. "It does not circle" means circling to the left. According to the treatise of the glorious Vajrabhūti, "circling all around" is momentary arising, and "it does not circle" is having dissolved.

"From joining the firewood of the two organs": this is the practice in which means and wisdom embrace in union, and the great sādhana.

On "With the wind one should make the fire blaze": the Blessed Lady Vajradhātvīśvarī, whose nature is caṇḍālī, the fierce inner fire, and who is to be stirred by the natural wind just mentioned, blazes.

On "the ghee that abides in the upper wheel": "upper" is the wheel of great bliss, and "ghee" is the awakening mind. What does this say? By the light rays of caṇḍālī, drawn inward by the natural wind, the ghee of the awakening mind that abides in great bliss melts. According to the treatise of the glorious Mahāsukha, the upper wheel is the supreme wheel into which it is drawn inward from the emanation wheel. "That itself is the vessel" is said to mean the vessel of the precious Buddha.

On "The syllable hā is shown in the form of the filling ladle," according to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, it is the seed of touch, the embodiment of the three channels. According to the treatise of Master Śabari, it is the center of the secret lotus of the wisdom consort.

On "Here the pouring ladle is shown as the vajra," the words "vajra jewel, staff, fire pit, bhaga" are just as the words say. On "the five faculties," it is as the words say. In the waxing fortnight, it is the five powers. "From the waning fortnight" indicates the joy of annihilation; this is the treatise of the glorious master. "At the full moon, request them to go" means the entry into the joy of annihilation from the place of supreme joy onward. According to the treatise of Master Kṛṣṇapa, the waning fortnight is the wisdom consort and the waxing fortnight is the means, and "request them to go" means that one should confer empowerment upon wisdom.

On "Outside the fire pit, not even half a drop, from the pouring ladle; not even half a drop should be cast away": "outside the fire pit" is outside the secret lotus, and "from the pouring ladle" is from the jewel of the secret vajra. The meaning here is this: when offering the ghee of the awakening mind as the oblation, one should not release it outside the yoni. According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, what is outside the fire pit is outside the vajra, and the word "pouring ladle" means the place of the precious secret. From there one should not release the awakening mind to an outer place. Since that is not to be done, it is not the oblation.

On "Buddhas and so on," in the secret meaning, the vajra master in person said this. "Buddhas" are the mind and mental factors. "Bodhisattvas" are the

five aggregates. "Are gods and goddesses" refers to the intrinsic nature of the elements. "Rākṣasas" are the sense sources. "The eight guardians of the directions" are the eight savors. "One should satisfy them with the offerings to be burned" means that through the nondual union of means and wisdom, one should delight them with the nectar of each other's awakening mind. If one asks why that is: by this the aggregates and the rest are taught.

On "Whoever worships Vajrasattva should offer with oblations," the treatise of Master Jñānabhūti says this: "Vajrasattva" is the glorious King of Great Bliss. "With oblations" means that one should worship with that nectar which is not emitted, which is natural joy; the meaning is that one should experience it.

The passage beginning "With the mantra hūṃ phaṭ" means that at the time of the fire offering of secret, equal giving, one should set out the form of the view in the heart of the vajra jewel, and the form of pha in the heart of the lotus jewel.

On "By that all the ḍākinīs are delighted": the word "ḍākinī" means the channels, and "delighted" means having become inexhaustible. "The other yoginīs and mātṛkās as well" are the outer channels. "They also bestow accomplishments" means, in the words of the treatise of Master Vasantatilaka, "It becomes the accomplishment of natural joy." The passage beginning "Thus explained" is just as the words say. On "It accomplishes all desires," according to the treatise of Master Jñānabhūti, it is the very flourishing of the channels and so on.

This is the explanation of the eleventh chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall set down the verses of the twelfth. On the passage beginning "The sequence of the five nectars is thus": in the inner meaning, "the five nectars" are the five maṇḍalas that arise from the ḍākinī. There, the wheel of body is Vairocana, the wheel of speech is Amitābha, the wheel of mind is Akṣobhya, the wheel of qualities is Ratnasambhava, and the wheel of action is Amoghasiddhi. In the outer meaning, they are the embodiment of the five substances. In the secret meaning, it is the King of Great Bliss, free of beginning, end, and middle.

This is the explanation of the twelfth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, on the thirteenth, I shall set down the profound points. On "The places such as Oḍḍiyāna," I shall explain the places and so on in five senses. "The

gathering of yoginīs" is the movement that occurs when the channels meet at the time of secret union. On "There they speak the language," according to the treatise of Master Śabari, they bring together each other's awakening mind. The tantra speaks of it together with the word "secret." According to the treatise of Master Palasavajra, "the secret sound" is the savor of the joy of excellent delight. According to the treatises of other masters, the word "secret" means gathering into each one's own family.

According to the treatise of Master Ratnabhūti, the secret language is the domain of a code of exclusion. According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, the secret language is spoken in order to show who is fortunate and who is not. The rest, liquor and so on, are stated just as the words say.

This is the explanation of the thirteenth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, on the fourteenth, I shall set down the profound verses. On the passage beginning "The characteristics of the limb, the mudrā, and so on," the vajra master in person said this: the word "limb" signifies means, the word "mudrā" signifies wisdom, and "characteristic" is the union in bliss. According to the treatise of Master Jñānabhūti, the limb is existence and the mudrā is nirvāṇa, and from thoroughly knowing these two comes the accomplishment of the mudrā. According to the treatise of Master Kṛṣṇapa, the limb is the supreme joy and the mudrā is the joy of annihilation. According to the treatise of Master Saroruhavajra, the yoginīs gather in order to examine closely the yogin in whom the accomplishment of the mudrā has become manifest.

This is the explanation of the fourteenth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, on the fifteenth, I shall set down the meaning of the profound verses. On "form and defining marks," the master in person said this: "form" is the awakening mind, whose intrinsic nature is entirely red. "Marks" are the essence of the aspects that appear outwardly. The words "and so on" refer to the places. The meaning here is this: the nectar of the vowels and consonants that constantly drips from the place of a yoginī's secret lotus will without doubt bestow the great accomplishment, because the three realms are born from the wisdom of the vowels and consonants. She from whom such wisdom constantly arises is of the family of the gods, not of humans. The intent is that it is not the case that another woman, one who is not a goddess, is unable to achieve the great accomplishment.

This is the explanation of the fifteenth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, on the sixteenth, I shall set down the profound verses. On "Listen to the mighty king of maṇḍalas," the master in person explained as follows, according to the instructions of the Ḍākinīvajrapañjara. The word "maṇḍala" means the essence of the surrounding circle. The essence is the ultimate awakening mind, whose intrinsic nature is the wisdom of emptiness; the surrounding circle is the wisdom of activity.

On "There dwells the lord of negation," according to the treatise of Vajrabhūti, this is the essence of the wisdom of emptiness, and the lord himself is the ultimate awakening mind, the awakening of great bliss.

Here "entity" is explained with regard to "the entity of hūṃ." "The entity of hūṃ" comes from the ḍāka of the vajra mind. "Entity" is the nature of speech, the essence of the awakening mind in which the conventional and the ultimate are nondual. "The third entity" is the enjoyment body (saṃbhogakāya), endowed with the major and minor marks.

According to the treatises of other masters, it is Hevajra, emanated from the glorious great Vajradhara in order to tame those who are hard to tame. He himself has the defining character called "the wisdom ḍāka." On "He dwells upon the disk of the sun": he dwells in the place of supreme joy. On "With the light of ten million suns": this is the essence of great brilliant light, renowned as natural joy. On "Embracing in union together with you": through the equal and nondual union of the great lady of excellent delight, it is the union in embrace with Nairātmyā. On "Having the form of a blue lotus": great wisdom, moreover, has the nature of space.

The treatise of Master Vīrabhūti explains the faces as the purity of the moments; some take them as the purity of the joys. As for the hands, because they make various means clear, the master in person explained them as the purity of variety. That, for the moment, is the account of the completion of the lord.

On the occasion of completing the retinue, according to the treatise of Master Jñānamūrti, that which consists of twelve is the maṇḍala of means, and that which consists of forty-four is the maṇḍala arisen from means. According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, that which is completed from the joy of savor through practice and sādhana is the wisdom maṇḍala, and that which is completed in an instant is the maṇḍala of the elements. According to the

treatise of Master Śabari, what arises first is the supporting maṇḍala, and what arises afterward is the supported maṇḍala. As for the fish, the makara (a sea monster), and so on in the hands, according to the instructions of the Ḍākinīvajrapañjara, they destroy illness and the like. For the later master, it is just as the words say.

On "Whatever abides in the twenty-four is the ground where the host resides": for the thirty-two goddesses who abide in the four wheels, the places, the near places, and so on are where they dwell. If one asks why: for the inner goddesses there are the inner places, and for the outer goddesses the outer doors and so on; and because the center has no support for abiding, the places and so on are the ground where they dwell. This is the treatise of Master Śabari. As to how, here, the twenty-eight places become the ground where the thirty-two goddesses dwell, the master explained it thus: in the twenty-eighth chapter, union and near union are made clear as the four, and with these the thirty-two are complete. That, for the moment, explains the excellence of the goddesses' places.

Now I shall set down the generation stage of purification. On "Then, through the generation stage, when it arises in all the channels," following the treatises of many masters, the vajra master explained this. First of all, through practice and sādhana, when it arises from the secret channels whose nature is outer and inner, the forms of the goddesses arise from it. That is the side of the generation stage. On the side of the completion stage, because apprehended and apprehender have been abandoned with respect to the host of goddesses abiding in the maṇḍala whose nature is outer and inner, they enter of themselves into that from which they arise; this is the purity of the channels.

On the passage beginning "Closing and opening": this has the nature of emanating offerings to the goddesses of the channels, and when the joy of great bliss arises, the wisdom mudrā (jñānamudrā) is absorbed within. The wisdom mudrā is free of elaboration, with the intrinsic nature of great peace. From the absorption of practice and the great sādhana, that very one is caṇḍālī, the Fierce One. According to the treatise of Master Śabari, she is the Fierce One because she performs fierce activities. According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, she is the Fierce One because she makes supreme joy flourish. According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, she is the Fierce One because her light rays are exceedingly great.

According to the treatise of Master Mahāsukha, closing applies to the vajra and opening to the lotus. According to the treatise of the princess Lakṣmī, "closing" means drawing upward, and "opening" means requesting it to go downward. According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, closing is śukra (the white element) and opening is rakta (the red element). Their union in equality, through their coming together, is the great vajra. Although she, arising from the vajra fire, is not of the nature of great peace free of elaboration, because she is pervaded by the light rays of supreme joy she blazes, burns, melts the awakening mind, satisfies the channels, and performs the offering to be made to the maṇḍala. Thus, it is explained, the great channel, whose nature is the lamp of wisdom free of elaboration, takes all the channels as its support and, through wisdom and form, accomplishes the aim of the transcendent wisdom-gnosis. The rest, taught before, is just as the words say.

On "That very wisdom of great bliss dwells in the maṇḍala": what, through the completion stage, is the empowerment of wisdom-gnosis, that itself is great bliss. The words "generation stage" mean that great bliss is attained as the aim of the sādhana. On the side of the generation stage, only practice and sādhana with an outer wisdom consort are held to apply; this is the treatise of Master Santagupta. If one asks why: because by constantly attending on a woman as wisdom consort, one's meditative concentration comes to decline. So the tantra itself taught earlier, as follows:

Mere looking is what is needed;
Likewise, not constantly with all.
Once opened, it gives rise to conceptual thought,
And by that, accomplishment is not attained.

As for "dwells in the maṇḍala," by the word "maṇḍala" the meaning is: "In that lord, great bliss constantly dawns." That in the maṇḍala too, in great bliss, support and supported are indivisible, is the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti.

On "The conventional and the ultimate, great bliss divided in two": the one of conventional form arises from the wisdom-gnosis of great bliss. If one asks why: when, from wisdom-gnosis, it dawns in the joys that are not ordinary, it is the consciousness of great bliss arising from joy and the rest. As for "ultimately," the line "Those that come about from themselves, and so on" is just as the words say.

On "Appearance, the tangible, union, and movement: that is the fourth": "appearance" is the embodiment of the conventional; the meaning is the

blessing of gazing upon the wisdom consort, whose nature is Nairātmyā, at the time of the empowerment of wisdom-gnosis. According to the treatise of Master Śabari, it is the fourth joy; the meaning is that the four, appearance and the rest, have become its root and its cause. According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, appearance is the path, the tangible is the agent, union is the action, and movement is the result. The rest, up to the end, "free from existence," is just as the words say: these are the four joys of the generation stage. That, for the moment, is merely the teaching on the four joys.

Now, as to how the four joys are combined through the divisions of the sixteen joys: on the first joys, following the order of the tantra, the treatise of Master Jñānamūrti explains thus. Through gazing upon the wisdom consort and embracing her, the first of the first union is the joy of desire, the second the joy of trembling, the third the joy of movement, and the fourth joy itself. That is the first joy. From the increase of desire through the coming together of lotus and vajra, the first of the second union is the joy of increase, the second the joy of strength, the third the joy of emergence, and the fourth supreme joy itself. That is the second union. When the awakening mind moves, the first of the third union is the joy of blazing, the second the joy of the drop, the third the joy of intoxication, and the fourth the joy of annihilation itself. The first of the fourth union is the joy of uta, the second the joy of manner, the third the joy of sleep, and the fourth natural joy itself. Such are the sixteen joys of union.

According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, at root there are four joys, and these too arise from the continuum of gazing upon the wisdom consort. The joy of desire and the rest are characterized as teaching the joys definitively; what concerns the principal ones is characterized as teaching them one by one.

On the passage beginning "That is the drawing in of uta": according to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, "the drawing in of uta" is experiencing as twofold, through the practice of the completion stage, the bliss whose nature is without support. According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, it is drawing the bliss back again from wisdom. The word "which" is said in order to make the questioners understand.

On "At the end of the three drops": the word "three" means the three joys, and their end is the fourth, natural joy. There, "the drop at the end" intends that

one should fully enter into annihilation.

On the passage beginning "The natural one should be known in sequence": in the four unions of joy, natural joy dawns in each in sequence. As for the rest, the place where joy and the rest are experienced is, in the provisional sense, from the crown protuberance (uṣṇīṣa) of great bliss up to the center of the wheel between the eyebrows: this is the word of the Blessed One. In the definitive sense it is the wheel of great bliss, the crown protuberance being the place where great bliss is felt. According to the treatise of Master Kukkuripa, the wheel between the eyebrows of the jewel of the secret vajra is the place of the ring of the jewel of the secret vajra; there is the place where the drops of joy are experienced. According to the treatise of Master Śabari, it is the time of its dawning.

From the wheel between the eyebrows to the place of the throat, on the path a little below, is the place of the supreme joy; and in the place of the vajra jewel of the heart, it is the joy of annihilation. That is the side of the generation stage.

On the side of the completion stage, on the passage beginning "the wheel of the navel": the wheel of the navel is the place at the center of the vajra jewel just mentioned. The word "groin" means its topmost ground; there is the place where the joys are experienced. "At the root of the knot" is the very wheel of the vajra jewel; there is the place of supreme joy. "The jewel's mouth" is the inner door of the jewel wheel; there is the place of the joy of annihilation.

On "the place within the vajra jewel," the guru in person spoke of many treatises. Foremost, according to the instruction treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, it is the place of the knot. According to the treatise of Princess Lakṣmī, it is from the center of the vessel of the precious secret. According to the treatise of Master Vajrabhūti, it is the vajra jewel when delighted. According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, it is near the mouth of the jewel.

This is the explanation of the sixteenth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall set down the verses of the seventeenth. On "The drop, the manner, the part, and so on," according to the treatise of Kamalaśīla, the place of the part is joy, whose essence is appearance. "Drop" is supreme joy, whose essence is the increase of appearance. The word "manner" means the joy of annihilation, whose essence is the attainment of appearance. In these is natural joy, renowned as the brilliant light of wisdom. The word "wisdom"

refers to the perfected nature, which comes from the joys. According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, wisdom is the basis found through the joys. According to the treatise of Master Śabari, it is the place of experience.

On the passage beginning "From the conceptual to the nonconceptual": "conceptual" is the generation stage, and "nonconceptual" is the completion stage. According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, the conceptual is like the kunda flower (jasmine), and "nonconceptual" is bliss whose nature is free of form. According to the treatise of Nāgārjunagarbha, the conceptual has entities, and the nonconceptual is free of entities. According to the treatises of other masters, the conceptual is existence and the nonconceptual is nirvāṇa. According to the treatise of the glorious Mahāsukha, the conceptual is supreme joy, and the nonconceptual is freedom from joy. "The place of the navel" is natural joy, by way of the nondual essence of these.

On "When it goes to the place of nectar": on the side of completion, the place of nectar is the place of nirvāṇa, and the place of nirvāṇa is the student's completion of wisdom. On the side of the generation stage, the Blessed One Vajradhara declared it to be the very awakening mind, whose nature is bliss.

On "They abide in four places, and pass through by the distinctions of joy," according to the treatise of Master Kṛṣṇapa, "they" are the drops of the awakening mind, and "in four" means the places of the forehead, the throat, the heart, and the navel. "Pass through" means reaching here. The meaning here is this: the intent is that when the fourth drop of the awakening mind reaches the place where they gather, at the forehead of the jewel of the secret vajra, it is the essence of joy. Further, the vajra master explained it thus: when the awakening mind has become the entity of the drop, then it is the conceptual itself; when it is joy itself, then it is the nonconceptual itself.

"Through applying the workings of the channels" is just as the words say.

On the passage beginning "the place of the lotus above the forehead": "forehead" is the first place of the jewel wheel of the secret vajra. "The lotus above" is the very lotus of great bliss that abides in the wheel of great bliss. "Like its crown protuberance above" means that, in a place outside the form of the wheel, the jewel that has the entity of a closed lotus is the crown protuberance. According to the treatise of Master Kṛṣṇapa, just as there is a crown protuberance on the heads of all the buddhas, so too on the vessel of the precious Buddha. Therefore the meaning is "the place where great bliss is felt." The treatise of the glorious Kukkuripa teaches it as the place of the

secret channels.

As for the passage beginning "below the navel," on the side of the generation stage it is just as the words say. On the side of the completion stage, according to the treatise of Master Jñānabhūti, the place of the navel is the center of the jewel of the secret vajra, and "below" is the place outside the door. Because it has the shape of a triangle, it is itself the place of the triple junction. "Above it" is explained thus: above the triangle. The word "navel" means the vessel of the precious secret, and "groin" means the center of the secret vessel. According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, the central place is the jewel wheel, the very treasury of great bliss.

On "Below the triangle, having the form of a navel," if one asks what meaning is then explained, the master explained it thus: it teaches the nature of the places for the descent of the awakening mind and the rest. Lalanā and the others are stated so as to be easy to understand.

On the passage beginning "the vajra tip," according to the treatise of Master Śabari, "the vajra tip" is the place of appearance, and "the vajra of mind" means the attainment of appearance there. "At the triple junction" is the place of enjoyment, and "is speech" means the increase of appearance there. "Navel" is the place of empowerment, and "body" is appearance. "Thus definite for the three bodies" refers to the joys characterized by appearance and the rest; to these three it shows a fourth, arising from the edge of the jewel's mouth.

Afterward, too, the meaning of what is taught in detail about that same point, ascending through the stages of the path, is explained. "Heart" is the place of the secret vajra jewel. "The vajra of mind" is the Dharma body (dharmakāya), which is known as "empowerment." "Throat" is the wheel of the vajra jewel. "The vajra of speech" is the enjoyment body (saṃbhogakāya), the intrinsic nature of enjoyment there. "Forehead" is the seat of the vajra jewel wheel. "The supreme vajra of body" is the emanation body (nirmāṇakāya), which is known as "non-appearance." The word "non-appearance" means passing from place to place. According to the treatise of Master Vajrabhūti, it is going to the first place; according to the treatise of the glorious Padma Śabari, it is going into the unborn.

On "the life and the rest that are present in its center," according to the treatise of the glorious Mahāsukha, the word "its" refers to the three joys that were just mentioned, and "life" is the fourth, the intrinsic joy. This, moreover,

concerns conventional bliss, from the standpoint of the generation stage. "Secondary life" is the joy of cessation. "The life wind upward from the heart" means that from the center of the vajra jewel the intrinsic joy, whose nature is conventional bliss, has dawned and appears everywhere. "From below the navel" means from the place of the vajra jewel's mouth, and the words "the satisfying wind" refer to the moment of dawning in the joy of cessation. As for "when," the intent is that the joy of cessation bears the characteristic of the satisfying wind. On this point, according to the treatise of Master Kṛṣṇapa, in order that delight may arise in the joys of ordinary passion: "When the satisfying wind arises from the soles of the feet, then the life wind goes upward." "The soles of the feet" are the door of the vajra jewel. From there the life wind, the intrinsic joy, by its own power and capacity, draws the satisfying wind upward as well. On "the satisfying wind makes its base in the place of the navel," according to the venerable Master Vasantatilaka the intent is this: in the secret lotus that abides in the navel place of the vajra jewel, merely by the satisfying wind going there, it becomes the very nature of the great secret, and the intrinsic joy itself is complete. That is from the standpoint of the completion stage.

From the standpoint of the generation stage, it is explained as follows. As for the root of the place of the vajra jewel's wheel: when, from the place of the crown protuberance (uṣṇīṣa), the intrinsic joy dawns, like a kunda flower, then the awakening mind, whose nature is the joy of cessation, goes to the place of the vajra jewel's opening. Regarding the lines

At that time, that life wind
comes to rest in the place of the navel,

when the joy of cessation arises, if the yogin has obtained the reality of the genuine wisdom-gnosis empowerment, then it becomes possible to touch the life wind. From that, in that very instant, the intrinsic joy is revealed in the navel place of the vajra jewel.

This is the explanation of the seventeenth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write on the profound verses of the eighteenth chapter. On the passage beginning "Through joining in the form of an embrace," according to the treatise of the Ocean of Saṃvara, the vajra master explains as follows. The word "embrace" means the staff of life and the Lady Free of Elaboration embracing together, like a female serpent within a gośīrṣa sandalwood tree.

According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, the lines

of the Nectar Lady and
likewise of the Nectar-Flowing Lady,
in the mind, by whatever sequence,
there comes to be coming and going

are explained in this way: the awakening mind, whose nature is the wind of consciousness, mounts the life wind, and at the time when the great passion of sublime delight arises, it dawns by way of the heart of Vajradhātvīśvarī (the Sovereign Lady of the Vajra Realm) in non-appearance, in enjoyment, and in empowerment. So the scripture states. The words "the great passion of sublime delight" mean the supreme joy.

"The life wind at the root of the navel" means that the navel is the place where the supreme and annihilation are nondual. According to the treatise of Master Ḍombipa, it is the place of the conventional intrinsic joy. "The life wind" has as its own essence the attainment of appearance. That jewel of great bliss, scattered in a mere instant and experienced, goes upward into the lotuses, which have the nature of the channels of touch, and makes them expand: that is the meaning. On "It abides in the center of the navel," the meaning is that in the lotus of touch, which has an expanded form, in the place of the navel, the jewel of bliss, possessed of the great light of great sublime delight, constantly dawns.

This is the explanation of the eighteenth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write on the profound verses of the nineteenth chapter. The union in which one joins together with one who has reached sixteen means, according to the treatise of Master Mahāsukha, the gathering and meeting of the descending semen (śukra) and the rest, which arise from the two navels of the secret jewel. On "What arises from the awakening mind should be made to descend into the lotus," it is explained as follows. The lotus is the vase of the essence of the maiden's kāli; into it the awakening mind should be made to descend. If one asks why: through the empowerment of such a vase one attains the state of a master. According to the treatise of Master Vilāsavajra, "the state of a master" means empowerment in the joy of annihilation. After the empowerment, one obtains the results of the secret empowerment and the rest. That is why the Supreme Lord himself spoke of "the supreme empowerment of the master." Were it not so, then because it would descend

outside the lotus, it would be nothing but annihilation. How could that become an empowerment?

Now I shall write on the meaning of the secret empowerment. "When the mind is in the secret place" means that the experience of bliss whose nature is without support is the genuine secret; this, for the moment, is from the standpoint of the ultimate. From the conventional standpoint, according to the treatise of the glorious Mahāsukha, it is the holding of the awakening mind within the secret jewel by both method and wisdom. According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, the proliferation that is not external is the secret. Therefore it is said in the tantra, "The mind is not the sky of the lotus." The vajra master explained the words "sky" and "lotus" as the intermediate.

Now I shall write on the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. "Wisdom" is Vajradhātvīśvarī, whose face is the full moon of the awakening mind. "Gnosis" is bliss free of substance, like the fragrance in a flower. "Empowerment" is the experiencing of it. That is in terms of the completion stage. From the standpoint of the generation stage, "wisdom" is the awakening mind that has descended from the secret lotus, "gnosis" is what has arisen from the vajra, and "empowerment" is their coming together with each other. The instruction on the sequence of the tantra's instructions, the treatise of Master Saroruhavajra, is as follows. "Empowerment" is causing the descent from the vajra vase through the jewel continuum. That descent, moreover, into the supreme limb of the wisdom lotus is the mudrā of the annihilation of gnosis; therefore, in the context of gnosis, it is not that at all. The glorious great Vajradhara has stated the meaning of empowerment.

According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, the empowerment of gnosis that the wisdom woman confers on the method partner is the wisdom-gnosis empowerment. The words "wisdom empowerment" mean the empowerment of uncontrived bliss. The latter part, which was taught before, is just as the words say.

"Its cessation is known as the fourth" means that the cessation of the drop of the joy of cessation is the fourth, which bears the characteristic of the intrinsic joy. According to the treatise of another master, the drop of the joy of cessation that is without essential nature is the fourth. As for the word "drop," the treatise of Jñānapāda explains it as the support of the subtle yoga. According to the treatise of Master Śabari, empowerment is conferred in the sequence of appearance, enjoyment, empowerment, and gnosis; for each

there are four drops of the awakening mind, so for the four empowerments the number is sixteen. These, moreover, have the essence of the inner vowels and consonants (āli and kāli). That is from the standpoint of the generation stage. From the standpoint of the completion stage, because the fourth has the characteristic of intrinsic gnosis, it is free of drops; so there, by the count of three empowerments, there are twelve drops, and these too are inner, having the intrinsic nature of the vowels. Their sequence is this: light, strength, cloud, manner, breath, utpala, delight, mind, heart, moon, sun, and the fierce one. These are the twelve that lack the four drops of the intrinsic joy, the consonant drops of the supreme joy. At the time when the joy of annihilation dawns, because it melts into the light of awakening, the basis increases; and because in increasing it is the moon, it came to bear both that name and the name "the vowel drop." According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, because it is born from the vowel gnosis, it is the gnosis of the vowels, the result that increases. According to the treatise of Master Saroruhavajra, because the awakening mind is the root, the gnosis of the vowels bears the characteristic of the cause; that very gnosis, through its ripening, is the result, the gnosis of the consonants. According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, it is the nondual nature of the union of the vowels and consonants.

On the passage beginning "Through Brahmā's door, the place of the throat," from the standpoint of the generation stage, the word "Brahmā" means the supreme limb of great bliss. Then, from that place as far as the limb of the secret navel, by the path through the middle of Brahmā's staff, from the drops of joy of the vowels and consonants come non-appearance, enjoyment, empowerment, and gnosis. On each of these occasions of irresistible gnosis, two experiences of the taste of touch arise.

On "the sequence of the four wheels": as for the four empowerments explained below, since there is no need for an outer wisdom woman, one should carry out the sequence of empowerment together with the inner gnosis mudrā (jñānamudrā). This is the instruction of Master Akraputi. The sequence is this: by spreading the four drops of joy in the wheel of great bliss, the vase empowerment; by spreading the four drops of the supreme joy in the wheel of enjoyment, the secret empowerment; by spreading the four drops of the joy of cessation in the wheel of Dharma, the wisdom-gnosis empowerment; and by spreading the four drops of the intrinsic joy in the wheel of emanation, the place of the feeling of great bliss, there is in the same way, likewise, the fourth. That is from the standpoint of the generation stage. From the

standpoint of the completion stage, for the three empowerments it is the vajra jewel. Their sequence is this: the vase empowerment is at the mouth of the vajra jewel; the secret empowerment is in the center of the jewel's navel; the gnosis empowerment is in the center of the vajra jewel wheel; and the fourth, explained in the same way, is the result of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment.

"Free of Brahmā's faces" means this: Brahmā, a son of the gods, has four faces, and the faces of the Blessed One possess the great taste that is free of those forms. That is taught in terms of the number of the twelve vowel drops. According to the treatise of the glorious Prahari, they are the faces of Heruka, whose nature is the eight great tastes. According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, "Brahmā's face" is the supreme drop of the awakening mind. According to the treatise of Princess Lakṣmī, "great taste" has the nature of the gnosis of Brahmā: the awakening mind free of drops. If one asks why, it is because it is the valid cognition of the arising of the intrinsic joy. On "half of twelve" and the rest, according to the treatise of the glorious Mahāsukha, of the twelve drops one should understand three for each empowerment and joy. Because it has the nature of the fourth, it was instructed earlier that it is free of drops and of joy. As for the rest, the meaning of what precedes and what follows is stated just as the words say.

This is the explanation of the nineteenth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write on the profound meaning of the twentieth chapter. "Conduct for the yogin" is explained as follows. "Yoga" means omniscience; "lord" means the equanimity of one side; "conduct" means serving as the support of the third kind of compassion. According to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, whoever has fully experienced the result of the genuine wisdom-gnosis empowerment, that precious person himself practices the conduct of the lord of yoga. According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, the lord of yoga who always abides as the self of all is definitively taught. According to the treatise of another master, one who has obtained the accomplishment of mahāmudrā is shown to be the lord of yoga. The rest is just as the words say.

This is the explanation of the twentieth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write on the profound verses of the twenty-first chapter. The passage beginning "the six taught earlier" is stated just as the words say. As for the rest, in the outer sense, at the time of extracting the seed letters for

the mantra, the lines

On a perfectly level piece of ground
one should make offerings with liquor and the rest

are just as the words say. In the secret sense, it is the mind whose nature is the supreme joy. "Piece of ground" is the source of phenomena (dharmodaya). The words "perfectly level" mean the very nonduality of method and wisdom. The word "offering" means engaging in what is to be accomplished and the means of accomplishment (sādhana). Therefore the tantra itself teaches:

Through the union of the supreme joy,
with one-pointedness one should give delight.

This is taught with reference to the flower that arises through approach (sevā). "In secret" definitively teaches the offering that is both outer and inner in nature. The rest is just as the words say.

On "Having made the vowels and consonants equal," in the outer sense the meaning is that they should be written so that they are neither unequal nor too few. In the secret sense, the supreme and annihilation: these should be made equal. So states the treatise of Master Indrabhūti. According to the treatise of Master Śabari, the meaning is that the taste of the white is made equal within the red as it arises.

On "The seven sages should be drawn," having drawn seven petals, the first group, one should afterward write the twenty-six consonants up to the syllable ha.

"First write Vairocana" means the syllable oṃ. "The fifth of the fifth" is the syllable ma. "The fourth of the sibilants (ūṣman)" is the syllable ha. "Joined with the second of the sixteen" means that the long ā is added. "The first of the first" is the syllable ka. "Joined with fire" means that the letter ra is added beneath. "The thirteenth vowel is added" means that it is adorned on top with the syllable o. "The fourth of the fourth" is the syllable dha. "With the eleventh vowel" means adorned with the syllable e. "The first of the sibilants" is the syllable śa. "The fourth of the semivowels (antaḥstha)" is the syllable va. "The seed of fire" is the syllable ra. "The third of the second" is ja. "The first of the semivowels" is ya. "The fourth of the semivowels" is va. "With the third vowel" means that the syllable i is added. "The third of the second" is ja. "The first of the eighth" is ya. "With the second vowel" means joined with the long ā. "The first of the third" is the reversed ta. "Reversed, join that same one again"

means with the reversed ta. "Then give that same one once more" means one should write a second reversed ta. "The fourth of the sibilants" is ha. "With the second vowel" means joined with the long ā. "The third of the sibilants" is sa. "The fifth of the fifth" is ma. "The fourth of the sibilants" is ha. "The second vowel" means joined with the long ā. "The first of the first" is ka. "The third of the semivowels" is la. "The first of the fifth" is pa. "With the second vowel" is the long ā. "The third of the first" is ga. "Join the twentieth" is ṇa. "Join with the third vowel" means joined with i. "The form of the wrathful one is greater than great" shows the surpassing power of that very mantra. "The third of the sibilants" is sa. "The fifth of the fourth" is ṇa. "Join it beneath" means with ṇa. "The fourth of the fifth" is bha. "With the second vowel" means joined with the long ā. "The first of the eighth" is ya. "The fourth of the sibilants" is ha. "With the sixth vowel" means: join it with ū. "With the crescent and the dot" means one should write on top the dot together with the crescent moon. "Then give that same one" means one should write a second syllable hūṃ. "The second of the fifth" is pha. "The first of the third" is the reversed ta. "The third of the sibilants" is sa. "With the fourth of the semivowels" means that va is joined beneath. "Together with the second vowel" means joined with the long ā. "The eighth of the ya group" is ha. "With the second vowel" means joined with the long ā. "Accomplishing all aims" means that it grants the accomplishments (siddhi) of mantra. According to another treatise, it accomplishes the activities of pacifying and the rest.

"By me" indicates the mantra of the Blessed One. "First, the lord of form" is the shape of oṃ. "The fourth of the semivowels" is va. "The third of the second" is ja. "Adorned with the seed of fire" means with the syllable ra beneath. "The first of the fourth" is ta. "With the eleventh vowel" means joined with e. "The third of the second" is ja. "With the thirteenth vowel" means with oṃ. "The third of the first" is ga. "With the seed of fire beneath" means joined with ra. "The fourth of the sibilants" is ha. "Joined with the sun" means with the syllable ra as its lower part. "With the fourth vowel" is the shape of hūṃ. "The second of the fifth" is pha. "The first of the third" is the reversed ta.

"The near-heart mantra" (upahṛdaya) is a limb of the root mantra. "First, Vairocana" is the shape of oṃ. "The third of the sibilants" is sa. "The fifth vowel" means with u. "The seed of fire" is ra. "The first of the fourth" is ta. "The third of the sibilants" is sa. "Twenty-five" is ma. "The seed of wind" is ya. "Join with the eleventh vowel" means with e. "The first of the sibilants" is śa. "Having the fourth of the semivowels" is va. "The seed of the sun" is ra. "The

third vowel" means with i. "The fourth of the sibilants" is ha. "The sixth vowel" means with u. "Adorned with the crescent and the dot" means adorned with the dot together with the crescent moon. "Then the same likewise" means one should write two forms of hūṃ. As for the rest, "making the mantra pierce" shows the might of its potency. "The second of the fifth" is pha. "The first of the third" is the reversed ta.

"The third of the sibilants" is sa. "The fourth of the semivowels" is va. "With the second vowel" is the long ā. "The eighth of the ya group" is hā. "With the second vowel" is the long ā.

"Your" indicates the heart mantra of the Blessed Lady. "First, the lord of the gods" is the shape of oṃ. "The first of the first" is kā. "With the seed of earth" is la. "With the fourth vowel" is ī. "Adorned with the crescent and the dot" was explained before. "The fourth of the semivowels" is va. "With the seed of earth beneath" means with la. "With the fourth vowel" means with ī. "Fully adorned with the crescent and the dot" is as before. "The third of the second" is ja. "With the seed of earth beneath" is la. "With the fourth vowel" means with ī. "Adorned with the crescent moon and the dot" means just what it says. "The second of the fifth" is pha. "The first of the third" is the reversed ta. "svāhā at the end" means just what it says. "The near-heart mantra" means a limb of the Blessed Lady's root mantra. The rest is just as the words say. "hri dhiṃ khaṃ" means that one should distribute the five nectars with the mantra of the seeds of body, speech, and mind; the meaning is that they are consecrated. The intent is that one should partake of them by means of the seed letters ya ra la va.

This is the explanation of the twenty-first chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write on the profound verses of the twenty-second chapter. The passage beginning "Protection for sentient beings" is explained in its secret sense according to the treatise of Master Śabari. "Sentient beings" means the awakening mind that arises from non-ordinary accomplishment and means of accomplishment. "Protecting" means holding it properly in the wheel of the vajra jewel. "Torma" means experiencing it through the supreme joy itself. "For the sake of" is said because it is knowledge that transcends the world. "In charnel grounds and the like" means in the place where the conceptual thoughts of desire are burned. "Riverbank" means in the place where the awakening mind passes; according to the treatise of another master, in the

place of the root of life. "The edge of the domain" means in a place other than the supreme joy. If one asks why: abiding in the domain is never great, so there is no joy; and because it causes harm, the meaning is that the secret torma should be cast in a place where the joy of cessation is absent. Alternatively, "on a mountain" means in the lofty place of the buddha jewel; so says the treatise of Master Akrabhūti. "At the place of a solitary tree" means at the staff of support that is free of elaboration. "Empty house" is the intrinsic joy, the place free of all afflictions. "Other mātṛkās (mother goddesses) and so on" are, in the outer sense, all just as the words say.

This is the explanation of the twenty-second chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write on the profound verses of the twenty-third chapter. On the lines

In the secret, the supreme, and the place of delight,
there one should fully turn the wheel,

according to the treatise of the glorious Mahāsukha, "secret" means in the place where desire is stopped, "supreme" means in the place where life is cut off, and "delight" means in the place where the king is summoned. "There one should fully turn the wheel" briefly teaches that one should hold a feast gathering (gaṇacakra). Afterward, the meaning of the detailed explanation of what was thus stated is also explained. "In the place where desire is stopped" means at the time when the permission empowerment is conferred. "In the place where life is cut off" means at the time when the wisdom-gnosis empowerment is conferred. "In the place where the king is empowered" means at the time when wisdom-gnosis ceases. "Gathering" is the assembly of the channels of touch. "Wheel" is the place that supports it, the vessel of the buddha jewel. "Fully turn" means complete enjoyment; according to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, it means satisfying.

According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, "secret" is the secret lotus: in the place of non-appearance, the joy of the vowels. "Supreme" is the joy of the lotus's navel: in the place of enjoyment, the consonants. "Of delight" is the most excellent of joys in the center of the navel, in the place of empowerment, where the vowels and consonants are nondual. "Feast gathering" means directly experiencing the expansion of the joys and of all the channels. That is from the inner standpoint.

From the outer standpoint, in order to gain the accomplishment of the mudrā, the vajra master, in the form of Vajra Heruka in whom method and wisdom are not unequal, is invited to be seated as the chief of the gathering on a variegated seat in the center of a maṇḍala of flowers and the like, and one should then worship him with offerings, oblations, and so on. Together with the gathering, having partaken of the secret feast in order to abandon conceptual thought, one should, for the accomplishment of gnosis, perform the vajra dance with vajra songs. Because one strives to gain the accomplishments quickly, at the time of making offerings to the master, since all phenomena have the nature of Nairātmyā, one should offer as a seat a corpse contracted by a spear-point weapon. The rest is just as the words say.

On the passage beginning "navel," the word "navel" means the essence of the deer, that is, vajra water. "The hare-marked one" means the moon, the awakening mind. "Joy" is what is luminous and arises from oneself. "Supreme" means Vairocana, that is, excrement. "Horse" means the nature of Amoghasiddhi, that is, rice. The arrangement of the seed syllables is just as the words say.

On the passage beginning "the inner Rasanā," according to the treatise of Master Vīrabhūti, the word "inner" means the inner lotus, and it is explained that the inner is also the secret. "Rasanā," which has the form of a bird's face, is the channel of the great Vajradhātvīśvarī. "Arranged on the lotus petals" means that one should meditate within the yoni lotus. On the passage beginning "outer and inner nature," the meaning is that the two lotuses just mentioned should be fully satisfied in equal taste and expanded with the awakening mind. On "the distinctions of the four wheels," the intent is that in every case it should be done through union, from the root.

On the passage beginning "First, the hero's taste-sensing lady," according to the treatise of Master Jñānamūrti, "hero" means the intrinsic joy; at the time of empowerment with the vase of nectar, on the occasion of the taste-sensing lady, it should be introduced at the door of the secret nose. On "The hero of heroes, in the center," "hero" means the intrinsic joy; "hero" refers to the time of the secret empowerment with the nectar of the supreme joy: it should be experienced in the center of the secret nose. "The lord of heroes, at the mouth" is the intrinsic joy. "Joy and hero" means the taste of the joy of annihilation at the time of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment: at the secret nose, the jewel mouth of the Blessed Lady Vajradhātvīśvarī, one should make offering with the nectar flower, the taste of the joy that comes from the

annihilation just mentioned. The meaning is that one should pay honor. If one asks why: those who have properly received empowerment have the authority to go to the feast gathering; or else, at that time, empowerment should be given to those who have none. This is the treatise of Master Akraputi. "Abiding in the center of the two navels" means that, for the heroes' joys, in the place of the jewel navel of both vajra and lotus, one should understand the meaning of empowerment through the guru's instruction and then experience it. The rest is just as the words say. "Mother and sister" means that, in order to abandon the conceptual thought of apprehended and apprehender, one should make the feast offering of method and wisdom. This is the treatise of Princess Lakṣmī. The rest is explained just as the words say.

This is the explanation of the twenty-third chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write on the profound verses of the twenty-fourth chapter. On "Then, further, what is to be explained," the word "then" is explained as "afterward": after the feast gathering of secret nature, one should accomplish the supreme action. The words "supreme action" mean that, on the occasion of the equal taste in which method and wisdom are nondual, the whole feast gathering should be kept secret. As for the meaning of "it should be made without essential nature," according to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, it should be made without appearance. "Seven births" and the rest means the essence of seven supports; it says that all should be satisfied through the secret feast gathering. The sequence is this: the support of union, the support of commitment, the support of manner, the support of movement, the support of time, and the support of ripening. "A gathering for the thrice-born" means the awakening mind of the three appearances that arises in the third path; because it satisfies the feast gathering of secret nature, it is the supreme action. The rest is just as the words say, since it is easy to understand.

This is the explanation of the twenty-fourth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now I shall write on the profound verses of the twenty-fifth chapter. On the passage beginning "Through the even union of life and inhalation," according to the treatise of Master Śabari, it is the awakening mind whose own nature is the disciple's mental consciousness, from the place of joy into the place of the other. On the words "inhalation" and "of the other," "having made it abide in the place of the intrinsic joy" is to be examined closely through the guru's

instruction:

The very joys of the supreme and of annihilation,
life and inhalation, should be eaten,

that is, they should be experienced. That is from the standpoint of the generation stage. From the standpoint of the completion stage, the bliss free of the aspects whose nature is the supreme and annihilation is brought to cessation; having made it without appearance, one should view life and inhalation as equal. The meaning is that great emptiness itself should be beheld with gnosis. That is the inner explanation by way of the two stages. In the outer sense, one should properly practice method and wisdom joined in embrace in the lotus. In the secret sense, the meaning is that in the space of the heart's essence, like letters of stainless crystal, one should turn back the garland of the awakening mind from the wheel of emanation and then draw it downward from the upper wheel. In the secret sense, the explanation of the stages of recitation after reciting the syllable ha is the treatise of the glorious Avadhūtī. "Softly" means that at the time when the supreme joy arises, one should recite in the manner of a very subtle touch. "Reciting" is for the sake of the complete enjoyment of recitation. "Without moving throat or palate" is because the channels in the abode of complete enjoyment do not move. "In the heart" means that, from the place where great bliss is felt, one should not perform the secret recitation by the method of experiencing the soft inner touch in another place. This is the instruction of Master Akraputi. If one asks why, the intent is that it is because the ultimate brings to cessation what has the nature of conventional bliss. In terms of gnosis, wisdom is the essence of caṇḍālī (the inner fire), and method is the bliss without foundation; that is the treatise of Master Vimalamitra. On the passage beginning "Having sat in the vajra posture, the mind," because gnosis that is indestructible like a vajra is endless, what arises is called the awakening mind. According to the treatise of another master, the awakening mind that arises from both method and wisdom, whose nature is the nonduality of the conventional and the ultimate, should be kept from moving away from the ground of cessation.

In terms of the arising of gnosis, according to the treatise of the glorious Mahāsukha, on "The secret recitation is without crescent, drop, and manner," the king of bliss, free of appearance and the rest, should be experienced in the place where great bliss is felt. That is the specific teaching on what arises from gnosis. According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, the gnosis that is the three appearances free of drop, manner, and crescent is none other than

the intrinsic joy. That is from the inner standpoint. The gnosis that has the nature of drop, manner, and crescent, known as enjoyment, non-appearance, and empowerment, is also the intrinsic joy that has the nature of all aspects. That is from the various standpoints. The third: the great gnosis that abides within drop, manner, and crescent and has the nature of the three joys is the genuine intrinsic joy. That is from the secret standpoint.

As for that, I shall explain, in terms of the perfected result, the coded language of the stage of mantra recitation. As for "Within the crescent, mind and the rest": because it is so exceedingly profound, the word "crescent" denotes the joy of annihilation. "Mind" means the awakening mind, and "within" means reaching its limbs. "Mind within the manner" is explained as follows: the drop is the supreme joy, and emptiness is the intrinsic joy. One should cause the gnosis renowned as the supreme joy to enter fully into the intrinsic joy. The meaning is that one should experience the intrinsic joy alone, in every aspect. The teaching that, because it is free of the three joys, it is the intrinsic nature of emptiness, is the word of the Blessed One in the definitive sense.

This is the explanation of the twenty-fifth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, for the twenty-sixth chapter, I write on the profound verses.

Time is taught to be the digit;
The intent of their union.

On this, the treatise of oral instructions of the revered one, the glorious Mahāsukha, explains as follows. "Time" (kāla) means experiencing the joy that transcends the world, and "digit" (kalā) is Mahāmudrā itself. According to the treatise of oral instructions of the revered master Ḍombipa, the digit is the Lady Free of Elaboration and time is the awakening mind. According to the treatise of the master Kṛṣṇapa, the digit is wisdom and time is skillful means. According to the treatise of Princess Lakṣmī, "digit" and "time" are the rising and the setting within bliss. In the treatise of oral instructions of the revered one, the glorious Indrabhūti, it is taught just as it has been handed down through the lineage. The meaning here is this: the full moon, which has the nature of fifteen, is the supporting digit; the sun, which has the nature of the sixteenfold joy, is the supported time; and their union is precisely their having become one in intent.

"Divided into four and four" is explained as follows: what has the nature of sixteen is the four unions of the support of the staff of life, each of which is

further divided into four. Thus the meaning is that, counted in sequence, it has the nature of sixteen. "Free of the aspect of a single limb" is explained as follows: the union that has the nature of sixteen is free of conceptual thought, because everything is full and because it is unborn; so states the scripture. Moreover, the intent is that this very thing is experienced in what has the nature of fifteen. Because it serves to bring the immature to understanding, the outer, numerical union of sixteen has neither fault nor virtue.

Now, regarding the sixteenfold gnosis, I write on the excellence of place. "Life" is the awakening mind. The "staff" is pervaded by the reality of the Word from the wheel of great bliss as far as the wheel of emanation; that is why it is presented as the support. According to the treatise of the master Ḍombipa, the staff of life is the awakening mind and the support is the wind of consciousness. According to the treatise of the master Śabari, the staff of life is the reality of the Lady Free of Elaboration and the support is the awakening mind. According to the treatise of the master Kṛṣṇapa, the staff of life is the reality of the life channel and the support is the Lady Free of Elaboration. According to the treatise of the master Indrabhūti, the staff is the form of the letter a. Because that very form accomplishes everything, the meaning of union with it has been shown above; and so "the staff of life in the center" means that the action of the awakening mind, the supreme nectar, is divided into three, having the nature of outer, inner, and secret. The inner is the central place; the secret is within it; and the outer is the place of desire. In the place of desire is the union in equipoise of the outer channels and the rest; in the central place, the union of the channels of touch and the rest; and in the secret place, the union of the secret channels and the rest. So says the treatise of the master Indrabhūti.

According to the treatise of the glorious Indrabhūti, there is no union of knots in the two places, the secret one and that of the central channel; it is present, however, in joy and the rest. For that reason the Blessed One Vajradhara himself said, "Rasanā possesses thirty-two knots; they are not within." By the word "knot" is meant the mutual winding of limbs in the channels, which are of outer and inner nature: so says the treatise of the master Okraputi.

On "It is union within the knots," the treatise of Princess Lakṣmī says that in the channels of outer and inner nature, in the center, through the eye of the knot, there is the very nonduality of the awakening mind and those joys. This, which is called "the digits are required," is the meeting of the channels. "The union of the digits is not within" denies their meeting in the secret place.

Therefore, because its intrinsic nature is free of conceptual elaboration, the Supreme Lord himself called it the Lady Free of Elaboration.

"Within the knots on the right and left abide Lalanā and Rasanā" means this: at the central place of the staff of life, on the right and left, are the two, Lalanā and Rasanā, which in the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā Avadhūtī are the essence of speech and mind. The life channel is body, and the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā Avadhūtī herself is free of body, speech, and mind. That is the treatise of oral instructions of the first tantra.

In the middle of every two knots, one each;
Of the thirty-two, bear sixteen in mind.

This means: externally there are thirty-two, having the nature of knots. On the staff of life, in the middle of each pair of knots, one channel and one joy come together, and so in the midst of the thirty-two knots are the digits, sixteen in form. Likewise, because that sixteenfold joy has become of one taste, this is the meaning of "union."

As to the nature of the thirty-two knots, the enumeration in the text of the glorious Jñānatilaka is this. The first has the form of a triangle. The second has the eye of a white lotus. The third has a fierce eye. The fourth is like a jasmine flower. The fifth is like the eye of Brahmā. The sixth is like the eye of a conch. The seventh is like the opening of an ear. The eighth is like the eye of a cow. The ninth is like the center of a conch. The tenth is like the navel of an elephant. The eleventh is like the center of a blue lotus. The twelfth is like the center of a lotus. The thirteenth is like the mouth of a bee. The fourteenth is like the beak of a peacock. The fifteenth is like the tip of a vajra. And the sixteenth should be made like a sesame flower in full bloom.

The others dwell within those sixteen knots. Moreover, because they are not distinct, they rest upon the form of the channels of touch: so says the treatise of the master Vilāsavajra. On "a single thread of twelve finger widths, without knots": from the extremity of the wheel of great bliss down to the upper part of the throat, in that stretch there is no union with the channels of outer and inner nature. If one asks why: being extremely fine, it does not even enter into union. So says the treatise of the master Okraputi. "Apart from that, the rest have knots" is to be taken literally. "As far as the wheel of wind" means within the center of the secret lotus. From the center of the throat down to the neck of the jewel: that span is taught as the place of the sixteen unions.

Now I write on the sixteen unions in the order taught in the tantra. Because the joy of desire and, likewise, the digit channel of the Lady of the Trace become one taste, this is the first union. The second is the joy of passing beyond and the Lady of Strength. The third is the joy of going and the Nectar Lady. The fourth is joy and, likewise, the Glorious Lady. The fifth is fullness and, likewise, the Lady of Dust. The sixth is the joy of the ground and, likewise, the Intoxicated Lady. The seventh is the joy of arising and, likewise, the Lady of Night. The eighth is the supreme joy and, likewise, Rasanā. The ninth is the joy of the Blazing and, likewise, the Peaceful Lady. The tenth is the joy of the drop and, likewise, the Dark Lady. The eleventh is the joy of intoxication and, likewise, the Lady of Exhaustion. The twelfth is the joy of annihilation and, likewise, the Shifting Lady. The thirteenth is the joy of uti and, likewise, the Moving Lady. The fourteenth is the joy of the manner and, likewise, the Wind Lady. The fifteenth is the joy of sleep and, likewise, the Lady of Flame. The sixteenth is the intrinsic joy and, likewise, the Generating Lady.

As soon as it reaches the neck of the jewel,
Recall it as the full moon.

So it was taught above. The passage beginning "That itself rises" means that it is completely perfected and utterly clear: this is the oral instruction of the master Okraputi. This is because it was taught above:

Ten and five are the cause of arising;
In the sixteenth there is no conceptual thought.

The scriptural statement, "Because there is neither rising nor setting, there is no union in it," is to be taken literally.

Now I write on the union of generation in the channels that bear the defining characteristics of channels. On "the sixteenth and likewise the sun," the treatise of the glorious Padmaśīkari, born of the revered great king Indrabhūti himself, explains as follows. "The sixteenth" is the reality of the awakening mind, whose essence is the nonduality of the conventional and the ultimate. "The sun" is similar to that, but because its light is greater, it is the reality of the letter ra. On "where the two come into union": "the two" are the form of the letter ta and the form of the letter ra. "Where they unite" is the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā herself, renowned as Avadhūtī, the Unborn Lady. On "that intrinsic nature is the defining characteristic": it is the venerable lord of the intrinsic joy, whose essence is inseparable from the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā, the king of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka. As for the passage beginning

The sixteenth and suchness
Are the cause of the arising of the digits,

because it is easy to understand, it is explained just as the words say.

This is the explanation of the twenty-sixth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, for the twenty-seventh chapter, I write on the verses. "Clarity about the hidden mantra" means this: from a person who commits the ten unwholesome acts the secret mantra is hidden, and so too are the renowned syllables. To the person who practices virtue, and likewise to one who guards the secret words, everything should be made fully clear. Therefore the glorious Vajradhara himself spoke of those with faith and those without faith.

This is the explanation of the twenty-seventh chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Now, from the twenty-eighth chapter, I write on the profound verses.

Listen, Goddess Mahāmudrā:
The supreme aspect, the best of bliss.

On this, according to the treatise of the master Śabari, the sense of "the best of bliss" definitively teaches the exceedingly great bliss, the great appearance itself. On "For the yoginī it is not so," according to the treatise of the master Vīraputi, "yoginī" means this: because the intrinsic nature that gives rise to bliss is present within the woman of wisdom who has obtained empowerment through skillful means, she quickly achieves accomplishment from just a little Mahāmudrā. "For the yogin it is somewhat difficult" means that it is difficult because, even though skillful means has obtained the empowerment of wisdom, the place where bliss arises remains external. The passage beginning "found through the method of training" means that the meaning of Mahāmudrā, whose intrinsic nature is free of conceptual elaboration, is never found through methods that involve a support. Nor is it found through what is not a method. If one asks why: at the time of experience, when the method for realizing the bliss of touch is absent, then even the Omniscient One does not find it; so how could the yogin who is striving for accomplishment?

Accordingly, the Blessed One Vajradhara taught this method here. "In the place of the digit of the wheel of wind" means in the place where the intrinsic wind arises. "The Wind Lady and the Sleep Lady" means the flowing of the moon and the sun.

By way of the right and left sides,
The digit should be thoroughly turned.

This means: the word "digit" refers to the Blessed Lady Nairātmyā, Avadhūtī. On her left is the Lady through whom semen flows, and on her right the Lady through whom blood flows. The bliss that arises from intensely stimulating them: by this method, from the guru's oral instructions, Mahāmudrā is found. So said the Supreme Lord himself. "The center of the digit abides in the channel" is explained as follows: it is she who is renowned as Avadhūtī. In the central place of the one renowned as the lotus is the Blessed Lady Mahāmudrā, measuring a hundred thousandth part of the tip of a hair. "The place of the channel" starts from the wheel of emanation, and "the place of the channel" means that she abides pervading the whole extent up to the wheel of great bliss. So says the treatise of oral instructions of the revered master Brahmā. The passage beginning "In that, too" is to be taken literally. "Abiding in the nature of outer and inner" is by way of the union of embrace, in which the outer hands, feet, and so forth are evenly joined.

The inner nature is free of form and the rest. In the treatise of oral instructions of the revered Brahmā, the outer is Avadhūtī, renowned as the supreme object of touch; what has the essence of the inner nature is the joy of touch, the instant in which gnosis appears, free of drop and manner, fire and water, wind and space, and the rest. As for the passage beginning "Whoever does not know," according to the revered one, the glorious Indrabhūti, the meaning is this: whoever does not know Mahāmudrā as it has thus been shown is not a great yogin, even though he be the Blessed One, the Buddha; and though he be the glorious great Vajrasattva, he does not know his own essence. "The glorious Mahāmudrātilaka" is stated just as the words say, because it is easy to understand. The passage from "Having heard this" up to "he spoke thus," set forth by the compiler, is to be taken literally, because it is easy to understand.

"In the root tantra": according to the treatise of oral instructions of the revered Brahmā, this is the tantra of the great family; according to the treatise of the master Kṛṣṇapa, it is the tantra comprising five hundred thousand verses. In it, "The Blessed One has told me only in brief of the place of the other and the place of the self" are the words of the Blessed Lady's request. The Blessed One declared:

The place of the other woman is taught to be the bhaga;
The inner place is the navel.

On this, according to the treatise of oral instructions of Śrīdevī of Excellent Limbs: because the radiance of awakening pervades, the place of the other woman is Vajradhātvīśvarī; and because she abides within the navel, it is the place of the self. "By the other woman, outside the door" means the place of the vajra and the lotus, of the jewel of skillful means, and of the wheel: so says the oral instruction of the yoginī Bee's Womb. As for "The place of the other woman is union, or," this is taught in the Samāja and other tantras. "The place of the inner nature is the yoginī" is taught in the Mahāmudrātilaka Tantra and others. Moreover, union and the four close unions are the places of the twenty-eight given earlier. For the sake of completeness, the heavens, the domain of humans, the realm beneath the ground, and the summit of Mount Meru belong to the inner nature and to the outer. "The inner nature" means the heart of the wheel of Dharma, the heart of the navel, the heart of the wheel of emanation, and the heart of the secret tip. "The heart of the wheel of emanation" is the vessel of the precious Buddha: so says the treatise of oral instructions of the revered Kilari. The rest is explained according to its plain meaning, because it is easy to understand.

This is the explanation of the twenty-eighth chapter of the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka.

Here ends The Marvelous Illumination of the Profound Meaning from the glorious Mahāmudrātilaka, an extensive explanation of the inner and the secret, composed by the master Gambhīravajra, a master of Oḍḍiyāna who attained the accomplishment of Mahāmudrā. It was translated by the paṇḍita Prajñāguhya and the translator Yungdrung Nyingpo.

Translator's Notes

• In the author's opening, 'dri is read as 'bri, "write," as again in "set down the five," and the closing phrase bdag 'dri zhes thos so is rendered "I write it down, just as I heard it." In the second list of the five, the first item reads brjod par bya ba, "what is expressed," twice; the first is read as brjod pa, "the expression," as the parallel list before it requires. The unit of "the fifty-four" is not stated, perhaps verses. The tantra called gsang ba'i rgya mtsho could not be identified with confidence and is given in English as the Ocean of Secrets Tantra. The terse gloss of "Later," sngar phyung ba, is read as "drawn out from what came before." Glo bur ba is rendered "adventitious"; it may instead mean "sudden."
• In the first sentence on the six yogas, nyams par sbyor ba is read as mnyam par sbyor ba, "brought into union," as the gloss of yoga just before it ("embracing in union") suggests; and 'dri in the author's statement is again read as 'bri, "write, set down." The tenth section, dregs

chen, could not be identified with confidence and is rendered by its literal sense, "the Great Haughty One." The thirty-first and thirty-second sections are both called "the Ḍākinī" in the text as it stands. The sentence about what does not remain in the land of the ḍākas and ḍākinīs is obscure; yul du ma could instead be read "many lands," giving the sense that the sections remain in the many lands of the ḍākas and ḍākinīs, a saying handed down from one teacher to another. In the list of the six yogas, tshul and tshul tsam are rendered literally as "the mode" and "the mere mode."

• □□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered as written, "the four repetitions"; it may be a slip for □□□□□□□□□□□ ("the four unions") or □□□□□□□□□□□ ("the four conferrals" of empowerment), either of which would suit the context better. The authority cited as □□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified and is rendered literally as "the Brahmin-like One". □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as the epithet "Lord of Secrets" applied to the body of great bliss; the syntax of that sentence is compressed. The one of twelve years is assigned to the "speech empowerment" (□□□□□□□□□□□□); since the commentator equates the secret empowerment with speech, this is the secret empowerment, and the reading may be a slip for □□□□□□□□□□□. □□□□□□□□□□□□, the third of the four joys (viramānanda), is rendered "the joy of cessation" rather than "annihilation". The glosses on sister, daughter and wife are etymological plays on the Sanskrit words (daughter, duhitṛ, traditionally derived from duh, "to milk"). □□□□□□□□ here is the common noun "lord" (lord of the eleven empowerments, lord of yogins), not the name Īśvara.

• □□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "loving delight" (probably Sanskrit surata); the commentator glosses it as "without agitation". The single occurrence of □□□□□□□□□□ ("gift"), which does not fit, is read as a slip for □□□□□□□□□□. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "life and cutting", is rendered literally; the commentary takes the pair as the times of going and coming (perhaps of the breath), and the underlying Sanskrit is uncertain. The masters "of Oḍḍiyāna", "of Jālandhara" and "of Kāmarūpa" and "the Kashmiri master" are taken as designations by place; □□□□□□□□□ could instead be the siddha Jālandhara(pa). □□□□□□□□□ ("the bird-faced one") and □□□□□□□□□□ ("the secret tip") are coded terms whose referents could not be identified; they are rendered literally. The explanation of Vajradhātvīśvarī plays on the Tibetan □□□□□□□□, literally "rich in power": the channel is so called because it "enriches" (□□□□) the jewel.

• The words introducing the half-moon verse read □□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("for the sake of faith"); they are translated as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("in the provisional meaning"), the reading required by the contrast with the definitive meaning that follows and by the commentary's repeated formula "the Blessed One's scripture in the provisional meaning". □□□, a recurring term of the root text in this section, is rendered "mode" throughout; its precise technical sense here is unclear. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as a vocative, "O lord of loving delight", since the commentary says the verse uses words of address. The fire cakra is said to be "not at its center" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) as written; "at its center" (□□□□□□□□) may have been intended. The final phrase of the mistress clause (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is uncertain; □□□ is taken as "mistress". In Indrabhūti's list, the lengthening mark (□□□□□□□□□□) and the bindu dot (□□□□□□□) are signs of written Sanskrit letters. The sentence about sandalwood (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

elsewhere in this text called "the joy of cessation".
• "The great syllable" (□□□□□□□□) probably renders Sanskrit mahākṣara, where akṣara means both "syllable" and "imperishable". □□□□□ in "hard to destroy" literally means "difficult" and is taken in the sense of firm. In Ḍombipa's view, □□□□□□□□ ("not expanded") makes no sense in context and is read as □□□□□□□□□ ("fully expanded"). "Consisting of five hundred thousand" (□□□□□□□) is rendered literally; it may allude to the tradition of a five-hundred-thousand-verse version of the tantra. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is transcribed as written; it may stand for Anaṅgavajra. □□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□□ may be the same master (Śākyamitra). The masters □□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□ could not be identified and are transcribed as written. The quoted line about the buddha maṇḍala is ambiguous: it may mean that the buddha maṇḍala is absent while the stains remain, or that it is not obscured in that way.
• The five channels named in Sanskrit after Kukkuripa are "carriers" (vaha) of semen, blood, essential fluid, an intoxicating fluid, and urine. Bhaga is the female organ, mada an intoxicating fluid (here dripping from the "self-arisen flower," the female essence), and reto (Sanskrit retas) seed. In the root line near the end, the syllable ma is read as "mother," paired with "father" (pha) and with the commentary's account of Vajradhara embracing Nairātmyā; read as a negation it would yield "the mind of great non-attachment." The sentence about drawing an illustration seems to refer to a diagram meant to accompany the text.
• Several items in the list of natures are obscure as written: □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□, "openly"; "weariness" (□□□□) and "mistaken reckoning" (□□□□□□□□□□) are tentative. The summary line is translated as written, "twelve, with seven more," yet the list itself has about twenty-seven items; the Tibetan for "twelve" may render a Sanskrit "two tens," which would give twenty-seven, matching the twenty-seven places named below and the one hundred and eight natures as four sets of twenty-seven over a day and night. □□□□□□□ here is a watch, a period of the day, not a ritual term or a meditation session. In the glosses on "the secret anus," □□□ ("otherwise," "other") may in both places be a slip for □□□ ("anus"), which would give "the secret anus is the heart of the jewel" and "not the anus, but the source of phenomena"; it is translated as written. The tantra of the secret lotus, the twofold tantra, and the epithet Lady of Perfect Delight could not be identified and are translated literally; the name □□□□□□□□□ is given as spelled, Vajraputi.
• At the wheel of speech the text has □□□ ("nāga"), read as □□□ ("song"), which the list of natures in the verse just before this piece gives at that point. □□□□□□□□□□ is read as Kāmarūpa (□□ for □□), like the other masters named by region; it could instead be a personal name. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "the flute of the back," is taken as the spine, and □□□□□ in this list of body parts is the sexual organ, not "sign." In the glosses on "night," "wisdom" (prajñā) names the female partner of the practice. Ḍombipa's "bird-face" (□□□□□□□) is unclear and is translated literally; "weariness" (□□□□) is tentative. These signs follow the verse list of natures in the preceding piece, and suggest that there □□□□□□□ stands for □□□□□□ (urination) and □□□□□□ for □□□□□□□ (fainting).
• At the start, □□□□ ("liberation") is read as □□□ ("means"), the word of the root line that the gloss explains and with which it closes. In Indrabhūti's gloss on the meeting of the two tips, □□□□ ("doubt") is read as □□□□□ ("sides"), as in his phrase "the two sides of entity and nonentity" just below. "The self-arisen flower" (svayambhūkusuma) is a code term for menstrual blood, matching the glosses of the sun as blood that follow. The master spelled first □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ and then □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as one person; the name could not be identified and is romanized from the fuller spelling, and □□□□□□□□□□ is likewise given as spelled. As in the previous piece, □□□□□ here means the sexual organ.
• The root line "That itself is to be known as the mouth" has □□□□ ("alone"), read as □□□□ ("the mouth"), since the commentary cites it as □□□□□□□ and glosses it "mouth or door." In Ḍombipa's gloss □□□□□ ("ability") is read as □□□□□ ("setting"), as in Śabari's gloss that follows.

In "a canaka kernel," □□□□□ ("bone") is taken in the sense of Sanskrit asthi, the stone of a fruit; the root line itself has □□□ ("edge"). "Outer appearance" (□□□□□□□□□) is translated as written, though the lists that follow suggest non-appearance (□□□□□□□□). The clause about the mind dissolving "into a taking up" (□□□□□□□□□□□□) is obscure. Vīrabuti and Vajrakarkatiri are given as spelled and could not be identified; the title before Vajrakarkatiri (□□□□□□) is unclear and is rendered "royal," and □□□□□□□ before Śrībhadrā is read as □□□□□□□, "queen," as earlier in the passage. □□□□□□ is taken as a spelling of Lakṣmī. "The sovereign yoginī" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) may be a personal name that could not be identified.

• "The thirty-three consonants" renders □□□□□□□, normally "minor marks," which here translates Sanskrit vyañjana, a word that also means "consonant"; the thirty-three syllables from ka to ha are the consonants, as the sixteen vowels are the moon. "Slow" (□□□□) is translated literally; its Sanskrit original is uncertain. In the glosses on "slow" and "great taste," the Tibetan repeats the readings of "the master" and of the master from Oḍḍiyāna, the first time in garbled form, evidently a copyist's repetition; both are translated as they stand. Bheraputra's □□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□, "non-appearance," as in the triad of non-appearance, enjoyment and mastery in the earlier pieces. "Thorough joy" and "intense joy" both name the second of the four joys, and the three joys are here matched with appearance, its spreading and its attainment. "Joyful to behold" (□□□□□□□□□□□□) may be a slip for "hard to see" (□□□□□□□□□□□□), a phrase of the root text quoted earlier. Padmaśakha, Bheraputra and Vimalamudra are given as spelled and could not be identified.

• The opening verb is written 'dri ("ask"); it is read as 'bri ("write"), as in this commentary's parallel formula for the preceding joy. In the vajra master's gloss, 'dud pa ("bow") is read as mdud pa ("knot"), the word of the root verse being explained. "Intrinsic joy" renders rang bzhin dga' ba, the fourth of the four joys; "the joy of annihilation" renders chad pa'i dga' ba, which here names the third joy, called the joy of cessation in the preceding passage. "Supreme light" renders 'od rab, which the commentary identifies with intrinsic joy as the culmination of appearance and the rest. The terse glosses on "that" (what is to come) and "supremely" (the cause) seem to read the root verse in terms of result and cause; they are rendered literally. The authorities Vīrabu, Vīrabhūti, Jñānasari, Padmaśrīka, Santakuri and Vajrabhūti are romanized as the Tibetan spells them and could not be identified with confidence; Vīrabu and Vīrabhūti, both cited for instruction treatises, may be the same person. "The great Samāja Tantra" ('dus pa chen po'i rgyud) is probably the Guhyasamāja.

• The word "I" renders bdag, the Sanskrit ahaṃ, which the commentators analyze into its two syllables. "The encouragement given by the Tathāgata" (dbugs dbyung ba) could also be read as "breathing out," in keeping with the breath imagery of the glosses that follow. The root line "Water is hot to the life force" (chu ni srog la tsha) is rendered literally; its sense is unclear. The names Padmaśīkhari, Siddhi (dngos grub), Bhirapatra, Prahastista, Śukrāri, Mahāsukha (bde ba chen po), Padma Śabari, Utamaravajra and Sarvabhūti are given as the Tibetan spells or standardly renders them and could not be identified with confidence. "The Jewel Casket" translates the half-Sanskrit, half-Tibetan rat+na ga'u, which could not be identified. "The Tantra of the Supreme Name" (mtshan mchog gi rgyud) may be the Nāmasaṃgīti, and "the Ocean of Saṃvara Tantra" translates sdom pa'i rgya mtsho'i rgyud; neither is identified with confidence.

• "Great and excellent delight" renders legs dgyes chen mo, which may instead name a goddess or consort. The twelve places follow the yoginī-tantra list of sacred sites (pīṭha, upapīṭha, kṣetra, upakṣetra, chandoha, upachandoha, melāpaka, upamelāpaka, śmaśāna, upaśmaśāna); where that list usually ends with pīlava and upapīlava, this text has "the increase that pervades perfectly" and "the near increase," translated as they stand. "Because its action brings that from far to near" interprets the terse de ring nye ba'i byed pas. "Sarvabhūti's teaching on the reality of the tantra" may be the title of a work; it is not identified. The authorities Candrakari and Vajraviti are romanized as the Tibetan spells them

and could not be identified with confidence.
• Several names are translated by meaning because their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence: the charnel grounds rendered the One with Form, the Blazing, Host of Hells, the Terrifier and the One with Bells; the eight channel goddesses from Fierce Might to the Miserly One; and the Holder and the Nonconceptual One named beside Rasanā. "The royal Vīramati" renders rgyal mi, which is unclear and may stand for rgyal mo, "queen." The name spelled padma shrī ka ri is taken as the Padmaśrīka cited earlier. Vilavajra is given as the Tibetan spells it (bi la badzra). "The six faculties" renders dbang drug, which may instead echo the triad of empowerment, enjoyment and non-appearance named throughout this passage.
• "The glorious Great Secret Vajra" translates a name whose Sanskrit form cannot be identified with confidence; "the glorious master" (slob dpon dpal ldan) may likewise be a personal name. Palasavajra is given as the Tibetan spells it. The phrase yar na is taken as "in the waxing fortnight," in contrast to the waning fortnight that follows; it could also mean simply "above." "The form of the view" renders lta ba'i rnam pa as it stands; its sense here is unclear.
• "A code of exclusion" renders Ratnabhūti's 'dor ba'i brda, literally "the sign of casting off"; its exact sense is uncertain. "The lord of negation" renders min bdag, whose sense is unclear; Vajrabhūti's gloss reads its first part as the wisdom of emptiness and its second as the lord. The double negative closing the fifteenth chapter is kept as written: it says that a woman who is not a goddess is not unable to achieve the great accomplishment.
• Uta is left as the Tibetan spells it, since its sense here is unclear. The text's des don is read as nges don, "the definitive sense," which plainly answers "the provisional sense" just before it. Santagupta is given as the Tibetan spells it.
• "Freedom from joy" renders dga' ba dang bral ba literally; it likely stands for the joy elsewhere called the joy of cessation (viramānanda). "Delighted" renders rangs pa as written.
• The word chad pa is rendered "annihilation" per the house glossary; here it appears to mean the cutting off or loss of the awakening mind at emission rather than the philosophical view of annihilationism, hence "the joy of annihilation" and, for the awakening mind that falls outside the lotus, "nothing but annihilation."
Rendered by meaning because they could not be securely identified: spros med ma ("the Lady Free of Elaboration"), bdud rtsi ma and bdud rtsi 'bab pa ma ("the Nectar Lady," "the Nectar-Flowing Lady," perhaps names of channels or goddesses), and sdom pa'i rgya mtsho ("the Ocean of Saṃvara," which may be either a work or an author).
Vasantatilaka is cited here as a master ("the venerable Master"), though Vasantatilakā is otherwise known as the title of Kṛṣṇācārya's Cakrasaṃvara work.
"Experienced" follows the evident reading nyams su myong bas for the written nyams su myos bas; the particle bas fits myong, not myos.
kāli is kept as written; in tantric usage it normally names the consonant series, paired with āli, the vowels.
The last clause, rdo rje slob dpon gyis bar ma bshad do, is read as "explained as the intermediate"; it could also be read as "did not explain in the interval."
• The twelve items "light, strength, cloud, manner, breath, utpala, delight, mind, heart, moon, sun, and the fierce one" appear to be code names for the twelve vowel drops; they are rendered by meaning, since no Sanskrit equivalents could be identified with confidence.
Akraputi (a kra pu ti) and Prahari (pra ha ri) are given as the Tibetan spells them; neither master could be identified.
Brahmā's staff (tshangs pa'i dbyug pa, brahmadaṇḍa) is the spinal column, through whose middle the central path runs.
Uncertain renderings: rin chen rgyud ("the jewel continuum"), ye shes thub pa med pa ("irresistible gnosis," literally gnosis that cannot be withstood), and phyogs gcig pa'i btang snyoms ("the equanimity of one side," whose intended sense is unclear).

chad pa is again rendered "annihilation," as in the preceding piece, where it refers to the loss of the awakening mind at emission.
• The latter part of this piece decodes three mantras from a letter code, in which a letter is named by its place within its class of consonants (for example, the fifth letter of the fifth class) or by its place in the series of vowels, semivowels or sibilants; each decoded letter is given as the Tibetan writes it.
• Akrabhūti (a kra bhū ti) is probably the same master spelled a kra pu ti (Akraputi) in the preceding piece; each is given as the Tibetan spells it, and neither could be identified.
In the list of code words, sa lu ordinarily means "rice"; its intended sense here, alongside "horse" and Amoghasiddhi, is unclear.
The phrase mdung rtse'i mtshon chas bskum pa'i ro is rendered literally as "a corpse contracted by a spear-point weapon"; the exact sense of bskum pa here is uncertain.
• ro tshor ma ("the taste-sensing lady") is rendered by meaning, as it could not be identified as a name; gsang ba'i sna ("the secret nose") is kept literal.
The text reads phyogs phyogs su ("from the various standpoints"); since the three readings that close this piece are framed as inner, this one, and secret, phyi'i phyogs su ("from the outer standpoint") may have been intended.
Jñānamūrti and Avadhūtī (a wa dhū tī) are given as the Tibetan spells them; Avadhūtī is cited here as the author of a treatise and could not be identified with confidence.
• Cha (kalā) is rendered "crescent" at the start, where the commentary is still glossing the triad drop, manner, and crescent, and "digit" from chapter twenty-six onward, where it is paired with time (kāla) and explained by the digits of the moon. "The joy of annihilation" renders chad pa'i dga' ba, a play on cha; it appears to name the joy in which elaboration is cut off, close to the joy of cessation. Two phrases are obscure in context and are translated as written: bka'i dngos po, "the reality of the Word," and cha rnams dgos pa, "the digits are required." The master o kra pu ti is unidentified and is given as spelled, Okraputi. Drag pa'i spyan, "a fierce eye," may intend the eye of Rudra, that is, the rudrākṣa, but is translated literally. Dbu ma here is the central channel of the subtle body, not the Madhyamaka school.
• Rin chen rke is read as rin chen ske, "the neck of the jewel," in line with rin chen mgrin pa below; as written, rke means "waist." In the lemma "the sixteenth and likewise the sun," de bzhin nyid ma is read as de bzhin nyi ma, since the commentary goes on to explain "the sun"; the later verse with de bzhin nyid, "suchness," is kept as written. The sixteen joys and digit channels (the Lady of the Trace, the Lady of Strength, and the rest) could not be matched to Sanskrit names with confidence and are translated by meaning; uti is kept as spelled. The masters Vīraputi and Padmaśīkari are unidentified and are given as spelled.
• Three sources cited here are unidentified: in dpal lha mo yan lag rab, dpal lha mo is given as Śrīdevī and the rest is translated, "of Excellent Limbs"; the yoginī bung ba'i mngal is translated by meaning, "Bee's Womb"; and the master ki la ri is given as spelled, Kilari. "The places of the twenty-eight given earlier" renders an obscure phrase literally.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the

Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.